



ANSWERS & EXPLANATIONS

GENERAL STUDIES (P) TEST – 3789 (2023)

Q 1.A

- The **Therigatha** (songs of Buddhist monks and nuns) is a text associated with **Buddhism**. It provides an insight into women's social and spiritual experiences and describes women's experience of renunciation. It is one of the very few surviving ancient Indian texts composed by or attributed to women.
- It is classified as part of the Khuddaka Nikaya, the collection of short books in the Sutta Pitaka.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 2.B

- During the 15th century, the Persian style of painting started influencing the Western Indian style of painting as is evident from the Persian facial types and hunting scenes appearing on the borders of some of the illustrated manuscripts of the Kalpasutra (a Jain text).
- The introduction of the use of ultramarine blue and gold color in the Western Indian manuscripts is also believed to be due to the influence of the Persian painting. These Persian paintings, which came to India, were in the form of illustrated manuscripts.
- An illustrated manuscript of the **Nimat Nama** (Cookery Book) which exists in the Indian Office Library, London is marked by a new trend of painting at Malwa.
 - The manuscript was started in the time of Ghiyas-ud-din Khilji of Malwa (1469-1500 A.D.)
 - It shows Ghiyas-ud-din Khilji supervising cooking being done by maids.
 - In the *Nimat Nama* style, the Persian influence is visible in the scroll-like clouds, flowering trees, grassy tufts and flowering plants in the background, female figures, and costumes. Indian elements are noticeable in some female types and their costumes and ornaments and colors. In this manuscript, one can notice the first attempt towards the evolution of new styles of painting by the fusion of the Persian style of Shiraz with the indigenous Indian style.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 3.A

- The greatest Chola rulers were Rajaraja (985–1014) and his son Rajendra I (1014–1044).
- **Rajaraja destroyed the Chera navy at Trivandrum** and attacked Quilon. He **then conquered Madurai and captured the Pandyan king**. He also **invaded Sri Lanka and annexed its northern part to his empire**. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - These moves were partly motivated by his desire to bring the trade with the Southeast Asian countries under his control. The Coromandel coast and Malabar were the centres for India's trade with the countries of Southeast Asia. One of his naval exploits was the conquest of the Maldives. Rajaraja annexed the northwestern parts of the Ganga kingdom in Karnataka and overran Vengi.
- Rajendra had been appointed heir apparent in his father's life-time, and had considerable experience in administration and warfare before his accession to the throne. He carried forward the annexationist policy of Rajaraja by completely overrunning the Pandya and Chera countries and including them in his empire.
- The conquest of Sri Lanka was also completed, with the crown and royal insignia of the king and the queen of Sri Lanka being captured in a battle. Sri Lanka was not able to free herself from Chola control for another 50 years. **Rajaraja and Rajendra I marked their victories by erecting a number of Siva and Vishnu temples at various places.**
 - The most famous of these was the Brihadishwara temple at Tanjore which was completed in 1010. **The Chola rulers adopted the practice of having inscriptions written on the walls of these temples, giving a historical narrative of their victories.** That is why we know a great deal more about the Cholas than their predecessors. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**

- One of the most remarkable exploits in the reign of **Rajendra I** was the march across Kalinga to Bengal in which the Chola armies crossed the river Ganga, and defeated two local kings. This expedition, which was led by a Chola general, took place in 1022 and followed in reverse the same route which the great conqueror Samudragupta had followed.
 - To commemorate this occasion, **Rajendra I** assumed the title of Gangaikondachola ('the Chola who conquered the Ganga'). He built a new capital near the mouth of the Kaveri river and called it Gangaikondacholapuram ('the city of the Chola who conquered the Ganga'). Hence **statement 1 is not correct.**

Q 4.B

- **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** was born in 1309 and ascended the throne of Delhi (1351-88) after the demise of his cousin Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq.
 - He adopted a policy of trying to appease the nobles, the army and the theologians, and of asserting his authority over only such areas that could be easily administrated from the centre.
- **Statement 1 is not correct:** It was during the time of Firuz that **jizyah became a separate tax**. Earlier, it was a part of land revenue. Firuz **refused to exempt** the Brahmans from the payment of jizyah since this was not provided for in the sharia. Only women, children, the disabled and the indigent who had no means of livelihood were exempt from it.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Firuz Tughlaq was the first ruler who took steps to have Hindu religious works translated from Sanskrit into Persian, so that there may be a better understanding of Hindu ideas and practices. Many books on music, medicine and mathematics were also translated from Sanskrit into Persian during his reign.

Q 5.D

- **Recently, the Prime Minister laid the foundation stone of the 850 MW Ratle Power Project and the 540 MW Kwar Hydro Project.**
- **Ratle HE Project** is a run-of-the-river project proposed on the **river Chenab in district Kishtwar of Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir.**
- **The 540 MW Kwar hydroelectric project** is located on **Chenab River in Jammu & Kashmir's Kishtwar district.**
- Under the 1960 Indus Water Treaty (IWT) between India and Pakistan, the two countries share the waters of six rivers in the Indus basin that flow through India towards Pakistan. Of these, India has complete rights over three eastern rivers - Sutlej, Beas, and Ravi, while Pakistan has rights over the western rivers - Chenab, Jhelum, and Indus.
- **Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 6.A

- The southern end of the Indian peninsula situated south of the Krishna river was divided into three kingdoms: Chola, Pandya, and Chera or Kerala.
- The **Pandya** are first mentioned by **Megasthenes**, who says that their kingdom was celebrated for pearls. He also speaks of it being ruled by a woman, which suggests some matriarchal influence in Pandya society. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **The Pandya territory:** Occupied the southernmost and the south-eastern portion of the Indian peninsula, and it roughly included the modern districts of Tirunelveli, Ramnad, and Madurai in Tamil Nadu, **with its capital at Madurai. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- The literature compiled in the Tamil academies in the early centuries of the Christian era and called the **Sangam literature refers to the Pandya rulers, but it does not provide any coherent account.** One or two Pandya conquerors are mentioned. However, this literature shows clearly that the state was wealthy and prosperous.
- The **Pandya kings profited from trade with the Roman empire and sent ambassadors to the Roman emperor Augustus.** The Brahmanas enjoyed considerable influence, and the Pandya king performed Vedic sacrifices in the early centuries of the Christian era.

Q 7.B

- **The magnificent Shiva temple of Thanjavur called the Rajarajeswara or Brihadeeshwarar temple was completed around 1009 by Rajaraja Chola and is the largest and tallest of all Indian temples. Hence option 2 is not correct.**

- Bigger in scale than anything built by their predecessors, the Pallavas, Chalukyas or Pandyas, this Chola temple's pyramidal multi-storeyed vimana rises a massive, 70 meter (230 ft. approx) structure topped by a monolithic shikhara which is an octagonal dome-shaped stupa.
- It is in this temple that one notices for the first time two large gopuras (gateway towers) with an elaborate sculptural program that was conceived along with the temple.
- Huge Nandi figures dot the corners of the shikhara, and the kalasha on top.
- Hundreds of stucco figures decorate the vimana.
- **The main deity of the temple is Shiva, who is shown as a huge lingam set in a two-storeyed.**
- The hybridization and incorporation of several styles was the hallmark of Chalukyan buildings. The most elaborate of all Chalukyan temples at **Pattadakal** made in the reign of Vikramaditya II (733-44) by his chief queen Loka Mahadevi is Virupaksha temple. Another important temple from this site is **Papanath temple, dedicated to Lord Shiva. Hence option 1 is not correct.**
- **The Lakshmana temple of Khajuraho, dedicated to Vishnu, was built in 954 by the Chandela king, Dhanga. Hence option 3 is correct.**
 - A nagara temple, is placed on a high platform accessed by stairs.
 - There are four smaller temples in the corners, and all the towers or shikharas rise high, upward in a curved pyramidal fashion, emphasizing the temple's vertical thrust ending in a horizontal fluted disc called an amalaka topped with a kalash or vase.
 - The crowning elements: amalaka and kalash, are to be found in all nagara temples of this period.
 - The temple also has projecting balconies and verandahs.

Q 8.B

- **Ellora cave site is located in Aurangabad District.** It is located a hundred kilometers from Ajanta and has thirty-four **Buddhist, Brahmanical, and Jain caves.** It has monasteries associated with the three religions dating from the fifth century CE onwards to the eleventh century CE.
- There are twelve Buddhist caves having many images belonging to **Vajrayana Buddhism** like Tara, Mahamayuri, Akshobhya, Avalokiteshwara, Maitreya, Amitabha, etc.
- **Ajanta also has excavated double-storeyed caves but at Ellora, the triple storey is a unique achievement.**
- Buddha images are big in size; they are generally guarded by the images of Padmapani and Vajrapani. Cave No. 12, which is a triple-storey excavation, has images of Tara, Avalokiteshwara, Manushi Buddhas, and the images Vairochana, Akshobhya, Ratnasambhava, Amitabha, Amoghsiddhi, Vajrasatva, and Vajraraja.
- Many caves are dedicated to Shaivism, but the images of both Shiva and Vishnu and their various forms according to Puranic narrative are depicted. **Among the Shaivite themes, Ravana shaking Mount Kailash, Andhakasurvadha, and Kalyanasundaram are profusely depicted whereas, among the Vaishnavite themes, the different avatars of Vishnu are depicted.**
- Cave No. 16 is known as **Kailashleni.** A rock-cut temple has been carved out of a single rock.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 9.D

- **Nearly 40 years after India first signed the Antarctic Treaty, the Indian government has brought in a draft Indian Antarctic Bill-2022 to regulate and monitor activities at its research stations in the frozen continent.**
- The Antarctic Treaty was signed in Washington on the 1 December 1959 by 12 nations that had been active in Antarctica during the International Geophysical Year (IGY) in 1957-58.
- The 12 original signatories were: Argentina, **Australia**, Belgium, Chile, France, Japan, New Zealand, Norway, South Africa, the United Kingdom, the United States, and **Russia** (erstwhile USSR). **India and Ukraine are also members of it.**
- **The Treaty provides that any member of the United Nations can join and now the membership has reached 54.**
- Activities in Antarctica are governed through the Antarctic Treaty System (ATS) rules, provided by the original Treaty along with three international agreements, negotiated during the Antarctic Treaty Consultative Meetings (ATCMs):
 - **Convention for conservation of Antarctic Seals (1972)**
 - **Convention on the conservation of Antarctic Marine Living Resources (1980).**
 - Protocol on Environmental Protection to the Antarctic Treaty (1991)
- The objectives of the Antarctic Treaty are as follows:

- **Antarctica shall be used for peaceful purposes only; military operations are not permitted on the continent. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The continued freedom for scientific investigation and research
- To promote international cooperation and transparency in science, which allows for readily available data and research results
- Prohibits nuclear tests and the disposal of radioactive waste
- Provides that any visits to the continent comply with the Treaty
- Sets aside dispute over territorial sovereignty

Q 10.B

- **When the sufi saint died, his tomb shrine-dargah became the center of his followers' devotion.** This encouraged **pilgrimage or ziyarat to his grave, especially on his death anniversary**, as a symbol of his soul's oneness with God. People thought that when saints died, they were united with God and hence closer to Him than when they were alive. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **The practice was prevalent even during the times of the Delhi sultanate.** The earliest textual references to Khwaja Muinuddin's dargah date to the fourteenth century. The Dargah was evidently popular because of the austerity and piety of its Shaikh, the greatness of its spiritual successors, and the patronage of royal visitors. **Muhammad bin Tughlaq was the first sultan to visit the shrine as per the available references. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- **The use of music and dance, especially mystical chanting performed by specially trained musicians or qawwals to elicit divine ecstasy, is a significant aspect of ziyarat.** Sufis remember God by repeating the zikr (Divine Names) or by evoking his Presence through sama' (literally, "audition"), or the performance of mystical music, which **eventually led to the development of the Qawwali style of music. Hence statement 3 is correct.**

Q 11.D

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** The Chishti saints led a simple, austere life, and conversed with people in Hindawi, their local dialect. They mingled freely with people of the lower classes, including the Hindus. They preferred to keep aloof from state politics and shunned the company of rulers and nobles.
 - Unlike the Chishtis, the **Suharwardi saints** did not believe in leading a life of poverty. They accepted the service of the state, and some of them held important posts in the ecclesiastical department.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The Chishti order was established in India by Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti who came to India around 1192, shortly after the defeat and death of Prithvi Raj Chauhan. After staying for some time in Lahore and Delhi he finally shifted to Ajmer which was an important political centre and already had a sizable Muslim population.
 - After the death of Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Delhi in the middle of the fourteenth century, the Chishtis did not have a commanding figure at Delhi. As a result, the Chishti saints dispersed and extended their message to the eastern and southern parts of India.
 - ✓ The **Suharwardi order** entered India at about the same time as the Chishtis, but its activities were **confined largely to the Punjab and Multan.**
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** The most famous of the Chishti saints were the **Nizamuddin Auliya and Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Delhi. Hamid-ud-Din Nagori** was a well-known saint of the **Suharwardi order.**

Q 12.B

- **Recently, a series of unexplained cases of Hepatitis B in children has taken over the world. Many countries including the US and UK reported mysterious cases of a few children being diagnosed with Hepatitis B.**
- Hepatitis B is an **infection in the liver** which happens because of the **Hepatitis B virus or HBV**. The virus usually spreads through blood, semen, or other body fluids. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The most common symptoms of Hepatitis B are **jaundice**, fever, fatigue that lasts for weeks or even months, vomiting, loss of appetite, and pain in joints or belly. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It can be **prevented or protected against through vaccination**. When it is acute, the virus lasts a short time and doesn't always necessarily need treatments. However, it can get severe and lead to life-threatening diseases like organ scarring, liver failure, and even cancer. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 13.B

- The Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) covered parts of Punjab, Sindh, Baluchistan, Gujarat, Rajasthan and the fringes of western Uttar Pradesh. It extended from Jammu in the north to the Narmada estuary in the

south, and from the Makran coast of Baluchistan in the west to Meerut in the northeast. The civilization was marked by the emergence of cities for the first time in the history of the Indian sub-continent.

- The Indus Valley cities were prominently located on the banks of the river Indus and its tributaries. Some of its important cities included Harappa, Mohenjo-Daro, Lothal, Rakhigarhi, Kalibangan, etc.
 - The city of **Mohenjo-Daro** was located on the banks of the **river Indus**. The city is known for a number of finds including the Great bath, a sculpture of a Bronze Dancing girl, a stone statue of Bearded Man etc. **Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
 - The **city of Harappa** was **located on the river Ravi**. It was the first city to be discovered and hence the IVC is also known as the Harappan Civilization. **Hence pair 2 is correctly matched.**
 - The **city of Kalibangan** was located on the **banks of the Ghaggar-Hakra River** in the present-day state of Rajasthan whereas the river Beas flows through the states of Himachal Pradesh and Punjab. The site has given evidence of ploughed agricultural fields and fire altars. **Hence pair 3 is not correctly matched.**

Q 14.D

- **Pushyabhutis or Vardhana dynasty of Thanesar:** An important ruling family to gain prominence after the fall of the Gupta was the Pushyabhutis who had their capital at Thanesar (Thanesvara in Kurukshetra). The dynasty became influential with the **accession of Prabhakarvardhana, who was able to defeat the Hunas** and strengthen his position in the regions of Punjab and Haryana. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- After his death, his elder son **Rajyavardhana** came to the throne but he was treacherously killed by Shashanka, the king of Bengal and Bihar. **Harshavardhana then ascended the throne in AD 606.** He was only sixteen years of age at that time. Still, he proved himself to be a great warrior and an able administrator.
- We have two valuable sources that throw important light on the life and times of Harshavardhana (606–647). These are Harshacarita written by his court poet Banabhatta and Si-Yu-Ki, the travel account of the **Chinese Buddhist pilgrim Hsuan Tsang, who visited India during AD 629–644.** **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
 - **Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of Chandragupta II.**
- After his accession, Harshavardhana united his kingdom with that of his widowed sister Rajayashri (see above) and shifted his capital to Kanauj, and is described as the lord of the north (sakalauttarapathanatha). He brought Punjab, Uttara Pradesh, Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa under his control. Harsha wanted to extend his power in the Deccan.
- But **he was defeated by Pulakesin II, the Chalukya ruler, on the banks of river Narmada. The river thus became the southern boundary of his kingdom.** The death of Harsha in AD 647 was followed by a political confusion that continued up to the eighth century when the Gurjara Pratiharas, the Rajput rulers, emerged as a big force in northern India. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 15.B

- The most remarkable figure in the Bahmani kingdom during the period was **Firuz Shah Bahmani** (1397–1422). He was well-acquainted with the religious sciences, that is, commentaries on the Quran, jurisprudence, etc., and was particularly fond of the natural sciences such as botany, geometry, logic, etc. He was a good calligraphist and a poet and often composed extempore verses.
 - According to Ferishta, he was well versed not only in Persian, Arabic and Turkish but also in Telugu, Kannada and Marathi.
 - He had a large number of wives in his haram from various countries and regions, including many Hindu wives, and we are told that he used to converse with each of them in their own language.
- The most remarkable step taken by Firuz Shah Bahmani was the induction of Hindus in the administration on a large scale. It is said that from his time the Deccani Brahmans became dominant in the administration, particularly in the revenue administration.
- **Firuz Shah Bahmani encouraged the pursuit of astronomy and built an observatory near Daulatabad.** He paid much attention to the principal ports of his kingdom, Chaul and Dabhol, which attracted trading ships from the Persian Gulf and the Red Sea, and brought in luxury goods from all parts of the world.
- In 1419, the Bahmani kingdom received a setback when **Firuz Shah Bahmani was defeated by Deva Raya I.** This defeat weakened the position of Firuz. He was compelled to abdicate in favour of his brother, Ahmad Shah I, who is called a saint (wali) on account of his association with the famous sufi saint, Gesu Daraz.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 16.B

- **The Kalpa Sutra and the Kalakacharya-Katha, the two very popular Jain texts were repeatedly written and illustrated with paintings.**
 - Kalakacharya Katha tells the story of a great Jain muni of the Shwetambar school called Kalak. His sister and he joined the Jain monastic order at an early age. He was extremely knowledgeable and she was extremely beautiful. Even though she was a nun, she was abducted by the king of Ujjaini.
 - The story of Kalak Acharya Katha was added as an appendix to the Kalpasutra, which tells the story of the three types of special beings of the Jain universe: the heroic Vasudeva, the regal Chakravarthy, and the wise Tirthankaras. Kalpasutra describes the cosmogony of the Jain world.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 17.B

- The Mauryan Empire had an efficient and centralized administrative system. The chief source of information regarding administration under the Mauryan Empire is Chanakya's work, Arthashastra. Megasthenes also gives some information in his book Indika.
- Revenue in the Mauryan Empire was collected on land, irrigation, shops, customs, forests, ferries, mines, and pastures. License fees were collected from artisans and fines were charged in the law courts. The Mauryas attached greater importance to assessment than to storage and depositing. **The samaharta was the highest executive official in charge of assessment and the sannidhata was the chief custodian of the state treasury and storehouse. Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 18.D

- Akbar introduced a new land measurement system (known as the **zabti** system) covering from Lahore to Allahabad, including Malwa and Gujarat. It was based on Sher Shah's land revenue system with certain modifications.
 - Under the zabti system, the sown area was measured by means of the bamboos attached with iron rings. The zabti system, originally associated with Raja Todar Mal, therefore sometimes, it is called as **Todar Mal's Bandobast. Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- The Dahsala system as instituted by Akbar, the average produce of different crops as well as the average prices prevailing over the last ten years was calculated and one-third share of the average produce was apportioned to the state. The system was adopted only in the major provinces of the Empire covering Multan, Delhi, Allahabad, Awadh, Agra, and Lahore. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- Zabti system was further improved by Raja Todar Mal and was named as Dahsala system. Hence **Dahsala system was a further development of the Zabti system. Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 19.C

- **Charvaka was the main expounder of the materialistic philosophy. This philosophy came to be known as the Lokayata, which means the ideas derived from the common people. Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**
 - It underlined the importance of intimate contact with the world (loka), and showed a lack of belief in the other world. Many teachings are attributed to Charvaka. He was opposed to the quest for spiritual salvation. He denied the existence of any divine or supernatural agency. He accepted the existence/reality of only those things which could be experienced by human senses and organs.
 - This implied a clear lack of faith in the existence of Brahma and God.
 - According to Charvaka, the Brahmanas manufactured rituals for acquiring gifts (Dakshina). In order to discredit him, his opponents highlight only one of his teachings.
 - According to it, a person should enjoy himself as long as he lives; he should borrow to eat well i.e. take ghee). However, Charvaka's real contribution lies in his materialist outlook. He denies the operation of divine and supernatural agencies and makes man the center of all activities. **The schools of philosophy with emphasis on materialism developed in the period of expanding economy and society between 500 B.C. and A.D. 300.**

Q 20.B

- The teachings of Buddha form the core of Buddhism. Buddhism **did not recognize the existence of God**. Buddhism accepts the idea of transmigration (samsara) but **rejects the idea of the eternal atman (soul)**.
- Buddhism **does believe in the theory of rebirth**. According to Buddhism rebirth is governed by the cumulative results of the karma of a particular life. Karma means intentions that lead to actions of body, speech, or mind. **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

- The Buddha emphasized individual agency and righteous action as the means to escape from the cycle of rebirth.
- The **ultimate goal of the Buddha's teaching was the attainment of Nibbana**. This was not a place but an experience that could be attained in this life. Nibbana literally means blowing out, dying out, or extinction—the dying out or extinction of desire, attachment, greed, hatred and ignorance.

Q 21.B

- Jains were prolific temple builders like the Hindus, and their sacred shrines and pilgrimage spots are to be found across the length and breadth of India except in the hills.
- Karnataka has a rich heritage of Jain shrines and at **Sravana Belagola** the **famous statue of Gomateshwara**, the granite statue of **Lord Bahubali** which stands eighteen meters or fifty-seven feet high, is the world's tallest monolithic free-standing structure. **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**
 - It was commissioned by Camundaraya, the General-in-Chief and Prime Minister of the Ganga Kings of Mysore.
 - **According to the Jain texts, Bahubali or Gomateshwara was the second son of the first Tirthankara of Jains, Rishabhdeva, or Adinath.**
- The Jain temples at Mount Abu were constructed by Vimal Shah. Notable for a simplistic exterior in contrast with the exuberant marble interiors, their rich sculptural decoration with deep undercutting creates a lace-like appearance.
 - The temple is famous for its unique patterns on every ceiling, and the graceful bracket figures along with the domed ceilings.
 - The great Jain pilgrimage site in the Shatrunjay hills near Palitana in Kathiawar, Gujarat, is imposing with scores of temples clustered together

Q 22.A

- In the Vijayanagara kingdom, the king was advised by a council of ministers which consisted of the great nobles of the kingdom. **The kingdom was divided into rajyas or mandalam (provinces) below which were nadu (district), sthala (sub-district) and grama (village).** **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- The Chola traditions of village self-government were considerably weakened under Vijayanagara rule. The growth of hereditary nayakships tended to curb their freedom and initiative. The governors of the provinces were royal princes at first. Later, persons belonging to vassal ruling families and nobles were also appointed as governors.

Q 23.C

- **Nayanars- Thevaram - Hence pair 1 is not correctly matched.**
 - South India was home to **63 ardent worshippers of Lord Siva known as the Nayanars** during the 6th and 9th centuries A.D. The **'Thevaram' hymns were penned by three of the most renowned Nayanars—Appar, Sambandar, and Sundarar.**
 - Thevaram refers to the **first seven volumes of the twelve-volume collection known as 'Tirumurai,'** which is a Shaiva narrative of epic and puranic heroes.
 - These hymns were collected and **compiled by Nambiyandar Nambi** in the 10th century, during the **reign of Rajaraja I** of the Chola dynasty.
 - Beginning with the **Thevaram** and the rest of **Tirumurai** and finishing with the **Periya Puranam**, these **are considered the greatest Shaivism literature of all times.**
- **Alvars- Nalayira Divya Prabandham - Hence pair 2 is not correctly matched.**
 - Alvar denotes someone who is "completely immersed" in God's love.
 - These **12 poet-saints, are all outstanding Vishnu followers** and were from a variety of communities.
 - **They visited temples all over India, writing 4,000 hymns** in honor of Lord Vishnu. Theologian Nathamuni gathered these writings as the **Nalayira Divya Prabandham** (Divine Collection of 4,000 Hymns) in the 10th century and set them to music for temple chanting.
 - The **Divya Prabandham is known as the "Dravidian Veda"** because it translates the Vedic and Upanishad messages into Tamil.
- **Virashaivas- Vachanas - Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**
 - **Basavanna**, a minister in the court of a Chalukya king, **led the emergence of a new movement** in Karnataka in the twelfth century.
 - **His devotees were known as Virashaivas** (Shiva's warriors) **or Lingayats** (wearers of the linga).
 - They revere Shiva in the form of linga, and men typically wear a tiny linga in a silver casing on a loop.

- The traveling monks are among those who are members of the sect. Lingayats believe that when a devotee dies, he or she will be joined with Shiva and will no longer be in this world.
- **The Virashaiva tradition is based on Vachanas (literally, sayings) written in Kannada by members of the movement which included women as well, who were collectively called 'Vachanakaras'.**

Q 24.C

- Chaityas were the places of worship and congregation while viharas were the places of residents of Buddhist monks. **Hence both statements 1 and 2 are not correct.**
- In western India, many Buddhist caves dating back to the second century BCE onwards have been excavated. The front of the chaitya hall is dominated by the motif of a semi-circular chaitya arch with an open front that has a wooden facade and, in some cases, there is no dominating chaitya arch window such as found at Kondivite. In all the chaitya caves a stupa at the back is common. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**

Q 25.C

- **Hori, Kajri, and Sohar are the folk music of Uttar Pradesh. Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**
- **Rasiya Geet:**
 - The rich tradition of singing Rasiya Geet flourished in Braj which is the sacred land of Lord Krishna's charming leelas from time immemorial.
 - This is not confined to any particular festival but is closely woven into the very fabric of daily life and the day-to-day chores of its people. 'Rasiya' word is derived from the word rasa(emotion) because rasiya means that which is filled with rasa or emotion.
- **Alha, Uttar Pradesh:**
 - Alha, a typical ballad of Bundelkhand narrates the heroic deeds of Alha and Udal, the two warrior brothers who served Raja Parmal of Majoba.
 - This is the most popular regional music of Bundelkhand which is popular elsewhere in the country as well.
 - The Alha is full of tales of feudal chivalry, which appeal to common men. It highlights the high principles of morality, chivalry, and nobility prevalent in those times.
- **Hori, Uttar Pradesh:**
 - The history of Hori, its evolution, and its tradition are quite ancient. It is based on the love pranks of 'Radha-Krishna'. Hori singing is basically associated with the festival of Holi only.
- **Sohar, Uttar Pradesh:**
 - North India has a strong tradition of singing 'Sohar' songs when a son is born in a family. This has influenced the Muslim culture and a form of 'Sohar' song gained currency in the Muslim families living in some regions of Uttar Pradesh. 'Sohar' songs unmistakably point to the mingling of two cultures.
- **Kajri, Uttar Pradesh:**
 - Kajri is a folk song sung by women, from Uttar Pradesh and the adjacent regions, during the rainy season. On the third day in the second half of the bhadra, women sing Kajri songs all through the night, while dancing in a semi-circle.

Q 26.B

- Sufis were a **group of religious persons who turned to asceticism and mysticism in the early centuries of Islam to protest the Caliphate's growing materialism** as a religious and political entity. They **were critical of the Caliph's** use of assertive terminology and instructive ways of understanding the Qur'an and sunna (the Prophet's traditions). **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- **Sufis began to form communities around a hospice, or khanqah** (Persian), which was overseen by a teaching master known as a shaikh (Arabic), pir, or murshid (in Persian). They enrolled murids (disciples) and nominated successors (khalifa). **Within the khanqah, they also created norms for spiritual conduct and interaction between inmates as well as laymen and the masters. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- Some mystics started movements based on Sufi ideas that became radicalized. **Many people rejected the khanqah and chose mendicancy and celibacy instead. They shunned rites and practiced extreme asceticism. Qalandars, Madaris, Malangs, Haidaris, are some of such sufis.** They were sometimes known as be-shari'a Sufis because of their purposeful disobedience of the shari'a, as opposed to the ba-shari'a Sufis who followed it. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 27.C

- The Chalcolithic age began in different parts of India, after the Neolithic age. During this **people used metal (copper) for the first time**. Hence it is known as the **stone copper age**. However, **people were not aware of the art of writing during this period and no specimens of the pictographic script have been found**. The pictographic script belongs to the Indus Valley Civilization. **Hence statement 1 is not correct and statement 3 is correct.**
- The Chalcolithic people had a better knowledge of agriculture compared to the Neolithic culture and thus cultivated far more crops than the latter. In particular, **they cultivated barley, wheat, and lentil in western India, and rice in southern and eastern India**. Their cereal food was supplemented by non-vegetarian food. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 28.A

- Satavahanas became prominent in the Indian political scene sometime in the middle of the first century BC. Gautamiputra Satakarni (first century AD) is considered to be the greatest of the Satavahana rulers. He is credited with the extension of Satavahana dominions by defeating **Nahapana, the Shaka ruler of Western India**. **Simuka was the founder of the Satavahana Dynasty**. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct**
- His kingdom is said to have extended from river Krishna in the south to river the Godavari in the north. **The Satavahanas had their capital at Pratishthana** (modern Paithan) near Aurangabad in Maharashtra. The Satavahana kingdom was wiped out in the first quarter of the third century AD and the **Satavahanas kings were succeeded by the Kings of the Ikshvaku dynasty**.
- **Satavahana Society:**
 - The Satavahanas originally seems to have been a Deccan tribe. They however were so brahmanized that they claimed to be Brahmanas. Their most famous king, **Gautamiputra Satakarni, described himself as a brahmana and claimed to have established the fourfold varna system which had fallen into disorder**. He boasted that he had put an end to the intermixture between the people of different social orders. He considered it their primary duty to uphold the varna system i.e. the fourfold division of social structure. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
 - Indigenous tribal people were increasingly acculturated by the Buddhist monks who were induced by land grants to settle in western Deccan. It is suggested that traders too supported the Buddhist monks, for the earliest caves seem to have been located on the trade routes.
 - **Satavahanas kings were the first in Indian history to make tax-free land grants to Buddhists and Brahmanas to gain religious merit**. This practice became more prominent in succeeding periods. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Q 29.C

- Many of the **Sangam texts**, including the didactic ones, were written by the brahmana scholars of Prakrit or Sanskrit. The didactic texts cover the early centuries of the Christian era and **prescribe a code of conduct not only for the king and his court but also for the various social groups and occupations**.
- These categories could have been possible only after the fourth century when Brahmanas rose in number under the Pallavas. The texts also refer to grants of villages, and also to the descent of kings from the solar and lunar dynasties. Besides the Sangam texts, we have a text called **Tolkappiyam, which deals with grammar and poetics**. **Hence pair 1 is not correctly matched.**
- Another important **Tamil text deals with philosophy and wise maxims and is called Tirukkural**. **Hence pair 2 is not correctly matched.**
- In addition, we have the **twin Tamil epics Silappadikaram and Manimekalai**. The two were composed around the sixth century. The first is considered to be the brightest gem of early Tamil literature. It deals with a **love story in which a dignitary called Kovalan prefers a courtesan called Madhavi of Kaveripattanam to his wedded wife Kannagi from a noble family**. The author seems to be a Jain and tries to locate the scenes of the story in all the kingdoms of the Tamil state.
- The other epic, **Manimekalai**, was written by a grain merchant of Madurai. It **deals with the adventures of the daughter born of the union of Kovalan and Madhavi**. **Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**
 - However, this epic is of greater religious than literary interest. It is claimed in the prologues of the two epics that the authors were friends and contemporaries of the Chera king Senguttuvan, who ruled in the second century AD. Though the epics cannot be dated so early, they throw light on the social and economic life of the Tamils up to about the sixth century.

Q 30.D

- This image of the Buddha from Sarnath belonging to the late fifth century CE is housed in the site museum at Sarnath.
 - It has been made in **Chunar sandstone**.
 - **The Buddha is shown seated on a throne in the padmasana. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - **It represents dhammachakrapravartana. Hence statement 1 is correct.** The panel below the throne depicts a chakra (wheel) in the center and a deer on either side with his disciples. Thus, it is the representation of the historical event of dhammachakrapravartana or the preaching of the dhamma.
 - The body is slender and well-proportioned but slightly elongated. The outlines are delicate and very rhythmic. Folded legs are expanded in order to create a visual balance in the picture space. Drapery clings to the body and is transparent to create the effect of integrated volume.
 - The face is round, the eyes are half-closed, the lower lip is protruding, and the **roundness of the cheeks has reduced as compared to the earlier images from the Kushana Period at Mathura. Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
 - The hands are shown in dhammachakrapravartana mudra placed just below the chest. The neck is slightly elongated with two incised lines indicating folds.
 - The back of the throne is profusely decorated with different motifs of flowers and creepers placed in a concentric circle.
 - **The central part of the halo is plain without any decoration. It makes the halo visually impressive.**

Q 31.B

- The different types of string puppetry are:
 - **Kathputli, Rajasthan:** The traditional marionettes of Rajasthan are known as Kathputli. Carved from a single piece of wood, these puppets are like large dolls that are colorfully dressed. Their costumes and headgears are designed in the medieval Rajasthani style of dress, which is prevalent even today. The Kathputli is accompanied by a highly dramatized version of regional music. Oval faces, large eyes, arched eyebrows, and large lips are some of the distinct facial features of these string puppets. These puppets wear long trailing skirts and do not have legs. Puppeteers manipulate them with two to five strings which are normally tied to their fingers and not to a prop or support.
 - **Kundhei, Orissa:** The string puppets of Orissa are known as Kundhei. Made of light wood, the Orissa puppets have no legs but wear long flowing skirts. They have more joints and are, therefore, more versatile, articulate, and easy to manipulate. The puppeteers often hold a wooden prop, triangular in shape, to which strings are attached for manipulation. The costumes of Kundhei resemble those worn by actors of the Jatra traditional theatre. The music is drawn from the popular tunes of the region and is sometimes influenced by the music of Odissi dance.
 - **Gombeyatta, Karnataka:** The string puppets of Karnataka are called Gombeyatta. They are styled and designed like the characters of Yakshagana, the traditional theatre form of the region. The Gombeyatta puppet figures are highly stylized and have joints at the legs, shoulders, elbows, hips, and knees. These puppets are manipulated by five to seven strings tied to a prop. Some of the more complicated movements of the puppet are manipulated by two to three puppeteers at a time. Episodes enacted in Gombeyatta are usually based on Prasangas of the Yakshagana plays. The music that accompanies is dramatic and beautifully blends folk and classical elements. While Togalu Gombeyatta is shadow puppetry.
 - **Bommalattam, Tamil Nadu:** Puppets from Tamil Nadu, known as Bommalattam **combine the techniques of both rod and string puppets.** They are made of wood and the strings for manipulation are tied to an iron ring which the puppeteer wears like a crown on his head. A few puppets have jointed arms and hands, which are manipulated by rods. The Bommalattam puppets are the largest, heaviest, and most articulate of all traditional Indian marionettes. A puppet may be as big as 4.5 feet in height weighing about ten kilograms. Bommalattam theatre has elaborate preliminaries which are divided into four parts - Vinayak Puja, Komali, Amanattam, and Pusenkanattam.
- **Ravanachhaya, Orissa: It is a type of shadow puppetry.** The most theatrically exciting is the Ravanachhaya of Orissa. The puppets are in one piece and have no joints. They are not colored, hence throwing opaque shadows on the screen. The manipulation requires great dexterity since there are no joints. The puppets are made of deerskin and are conceived in bold dramatic poses. Apart from human and animal characters, many props such as trees, mountains, chariots, etc. are also used. Although Ravanachhaya puppets are smaller in size-the largest not more than two feet have no jointed limbs, they create very sensitive and lyrical shadows. **Hence only option 4 is not correct.**

Q 32.B

- **Recently, the Vagsheer, the sixth submarine of the P75 project of the Indian Navy was launched.**
- Under P75, INS Kalvari, INS Khanderi, INS Karanj and INS Vela have been commissioned. Sea trials are on for Vagir. Vagsheer is the sixth; its production was delayed due to the pandemic.
- Vagsheer is named after **the sandfish, a deep-sea predator of the Indian Ocean.** The first submarine Vagsheer, from Russia, was commissioned into the Indian Navy on December 26, 1974, and was decommissioned on April 30, 1997. The new Vagsheer will be officially named at the time of its commissioning.
- **Vagsheer is a diesel attack submarine, designed to perform sea denial as well as access denial warfare against the adversary.** It can do offensive operations across the spectrum of naval warfare including anti-surface warfare, anti-submarine warfare, intelligence gathering, mine laying, and area surveillance.
- **Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 33.C

- Akbar, the third Mughal emperor, founded the land revenue system under which continuity of cultivation was taken into account in order to fix the land revenue.
- **Pair 1 is not correctly matched: Polaj** - It was the ideal and best type of land throughout the empire. This land was cultivated always and was never allowed to lie fallow.
- **Pair 2 is correctly matched: Banjar** - It was the worst kind of land that was left out of cultivation for longer than 2-3 years.
- **Pair 3 is correctly matched: Chachar** - It was a kind of land allowed to lie fallow for **two or three years** and then resumed under cultivation.
- **Pair 4 is not correctly matched: Parati** - This was the land kept out of cultivation temporarily in order to recoup its lost fertility.

Q 34.A

- The political developments after Harshavardhan, can be best understood if we divide the period from AD 750 to AD 1200 into two parts (a) AD 750–AD 1000; (b) AD 1000–AD 1200. The first phase was marked by the growth of three important political powers in India. These were **Gurjara Pratiharas** in north India, **Palas in eastern India, and Rashtrakutas in South India.** In the second phase, we notice the break-up of these powers. It resulted in the rise of many smaller kingdoms all over the country. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- These powers were constantly fighting with each other to set up their **control of Kannauj** of the Gangetic region in northern India. The struggle for control over Kannauj among these three dynasties is known as the **tripartite struggle** in Indian history. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - Control of Kanauj also implied control of the upper Gangetic valley and its rich resources in trade and agriculture.
- The Pratiharas who first had their capital at Bhinmal gained prominence under Nagabhatta I who offered stout resistance to the Arab rulers of Sind who were trying to encroach on Rajasthan, Gujarat, Punjab, etc. However, the real founder of the Pratihara empire and the greatest ruler of the dynasty was Bhoja. He rebuilt the empire, and by about 836 he had recovered Kanauj which remained the capital of the Pratiharaempire for almost a century
- In the south, **Dantidurga was the founder of the dynasty called, the Rashtrakuta dynasty (8th AD). The capital of the Rashtrakutas was Manyakheta or Malkhed near Sholapur.** It was under the king Dhruva that the **Rashtrakutas turned towards north India in a bid to control Kannauj, then the imperial city.**
 - Soon, the Rashtrakuta king Dhruva from south India jumped into the fight. And thus began what is known as ‘Tripartite Struggle’ i.e struggle among three powers.
- **The Pala empire was founded by Gopala,** probably in AD 750 when he was elected king by the notable men of the area to end the anarchy prevailing there. Gopala was succeeded in AD 770by his son, Dharmapala, who ruled till AD 810. His reign was marked by a tripartite struggle between the Palas, the Pratiharas and the Rashtrakutas for the control of Kanauj and north India.

Q 35.C

- **Recently, Goa, Gujarat has topped the State Energy and Climate Index.**
- It is released by the **NITI Aayog.**

- In the first round outcome, Goa topped the NITI Aayog state energy and climate index in the smaller states category. Amongst the larger states, Gujarat had emerged the best followed by Kerala in the second position and Punjab in the third.
- In its first round, the index ranked the states in six parameters based on 2019-2020 data, where Goa had earned an overall score of 51.4.
- After Goa, Tripura emerged as the top performer, followed by Manipur. In terms of Union territories, Chandigarh, Delhi and Daman and Diu/Dadra and Nagar Haveli had the best scores in that order.
- **Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 36.D

- **Rise of Social Classes:** Income from trade, war booty, and agricultural produce enabled the king to maintain groups of professional warriors and also to pay the bards and priests who were largely brahmanas.
- **The Brahmanas first appear in the Tamil land in the Sangam age.** An ideal king was one who never hurt the Brahmanas. Many Brahmanas functioned as poets, and in this role they were generously rewarded by the king. Karikala is said to have given one poet 1,600,000 gold pieces, but this seems to be an exaggeration.
- Besides gold, the poets or bards also received cash, land, chariots, horses, and even elephants. The Tamil brahmanas partook of meat and wine. The Kshatriyas and vaishyas appear as regular varnas in the Sangam texts. The warrior class was an important element in the polity and society.
- The captains of the army were invested with the title of enadi at a formal ceremony. However, we have no clear idea about the vaishyas. **Civil and military offices were held under both the Cholas and Pandyas by vellalas or rich peasants. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The ruling class was called arasar, and its members had marriage relations with the vellalas, who formed the fourth caste. They held the bulk of the land and thus constituted the cultivating class, divided into the rich and the poor. The rich did not plough the land themselves but employed labourers to undertake this.
- **Agricultural operations were generally the task of members of the lowest class (kadaiyiar),** whose status appears to have differed little from that of slaves. Some artisans were not differentiated from agricultural labourers. **The pariyars were agricultural labourers who also worked with animal skins and used them as mats. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- **Several outcastes and forest tribes suffered from extreme poverty and lived from hand to mouth.** We notice **sharp social inequalities in the Sangam age.** The rich lived in houses of brick and mortar, and the poor in huts and humbler dwellings. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- In the cities, rich merchants lived in the upper storey of their houses. It is not however clear whether rites and religion were used to maintain social inequalities. We notice the emergence of the Brahmanas and the ruling caste, but the acute caste distinctions of later times did not exist in the early Sangam age.

Q 37.C

- The Pahari region comprises the present State of Himachal Pradesh, some adjoining areas of Punjab, the area of the Union Territory of Jammu in the Jammu and Kashmir State, and Garhwal in Uttar Pradesh. The whole of this area was divided into small states ruled by the Rajput princes and was often engaged in warfare. These States were centers of great artistic activity from the latter half of the 17th to nearly the middle of the 19th century.
- **Basohli:**
 - **The earliest center of painting in the Pahari region was Basohli** where under the patronage of Raja Kripal Pal, an artist named Devidasa executed miniatures in the form of the Rasamanjari illustrations in 1694 A.D. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - An illustration from a series of Gita Govinda painted by artist Manaku in 1730 A.D. shows further development of the Basohli style.
 - There is a change in the facial type which becomes a little heavier and also in the tree forms which assume a somewhat naturalistic character, which may be due to the influence of the Mughal painting. Otherwise, the general features of the Basohli style like the use of strong and contrasting colors, monochrome background, large eyes, bold drawing, use of beetle wings for showing diamonds in ornaments, narrow sky, and the red border are observable in this miniature also.
- **Kangra:**
 - The Guler style was followed by another style of painting termed the "Kangra style", representing the third phase of the Pahari painting in the last quarter of the 18th century.

- **The Kangra style developed out of the Guler style.** It possesses the main characteristics of the latter style, like the delicacy of drawing and the quality of naturalism. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The name Kangra style is given to this group of paintings for the reason that they are identical in style to the portraits of **Raja Sansar Chand of Kangra.**
- In these paintings, the faces of women in profile have the nose almost in line with the forehead, the eyes are long and narrow and the chin is sharp. There is, however, no modeling of figures, and hair is treated as a flat mass.
- The Kangra style continued to flourish in various places namely Kangra, Guler, Basohli, Chamba, Union Territory of Jammu, Narpur, Garhwal, etc.
- Paintings of the Kangra style are attributed mainly to the Nainsukh family.

Q 38.C

- The **Mauryan Empire** covered vast areas of the **Indian subcontinent**. It extended from the present-day North West Frontier Provinces of Pakistan to Andhra Pradesh, Odisha and Uttaranchal in India.
- The **Ashokan inscriptions** mention **five major political centres in the empire** – the capital **Pataliputra** and the provincial centres of **Taxila, Ujjayini, Tosali and Suvarnagiri**. The administrative control of the empire was strongest in areas around the capital and the provincial centres. The provincial centres were carefully chosen, both Taxila and Ujjayini were situated on important long-distance trade routes, while Suvarnagiri (literally, the golden mountain) was possibly important for tapping the gold mines of Karnataka.
- The **city of Manyakhet in Karnataka** was the capital of the **Rashtrakuta Empire** which arose during the 8th century AD. Thus **Manyakhet was not a major political centre of Mauryas.**
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**



Q 39.D

- The word Panchayat is an amalgamation of two words, 'Panch' and 'Ayat'. Panch means five and ayat means assembly, therefore, Panchayat is said to be an assembly of five members who work for the upliftment of the local communities and resolve disputes at a lower level.
- The Constitution (73rd Amendment) Act, 1992 which came into force with effect on 24th April 1993 has vested constitutional status on Panchayati Raj institutions.

- Accordingly, the Government of India decided in consultation with the States to celebrate the 24th of April as National Panchayati Raj Day. The commemoration is being anchored by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj. **The National Panchayati Raj Day (NPRD) is being celebrated on 24 April since 2010.**
- **In 1959, Rajasthan became the first state to implement the system in the country.** The scheme was inaugurated by the first Prime Minister of India, the late Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 40.D

- The **Mauryan empire was founded by Chandragupta Maurya** in 321/324 BCE by overthrowing the Nanda dynasty. Chandragupta established control over the northwest but also the Ganga plains, **western India and the Deccan. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The Sudarshana lake belongs to the Mauryan period. The **Junagadh inscription (150 CE) of Rudradaman** records the beginning of the construction of a water reservoir known as **Sudarshana lake** in the 4th century BCE during the time of the Maurya emperor **Chandragupta**, its **completion during the reign of Ashoka**, and its repair in the 2nd century CE. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The Mauryan empire declined rapidly after Ashoka. The **Mauryan dynasty came to an end with the last kind of Brihadratha** being killed by his own military commander Pushyamitra, who then established the Shunga dynasty in c.187 BCE. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**

Q 41.A

- **The image of the standing Buddha is an excellent example of Gupta art in its maturity from Sarnath.**
 - The softly molded figure has its right hand in the attitude of assuring protection.
 - Unlike the delicately carved drapery folds of the Mathura Buddha, only the fringe of the diaphanous robe is here indicated.
- During the Gupta period, the characteristic elements of the Indian temple emerged and the plastic forms began to be used admirably as an integral part of the general architectural scheme.
 - **The stone carving from the temples at Deogarh and those from the temples of Udayagiri and Ajanta are excellent specimens of figure sculpture in their decorative setting.**
 - The large panel of **Sheshashayi Vishnu** from the **Deogarh temple**, representing the Supreme being slumbering wakefully on the serpent **Ananta**, the symbol of eternity, in the interval between the dissolution of the universe and its new creation, is a magnificent example.
 - The four-armed Vishnu is reclining gracefully on the coils of the **Adishesha**, whose seven hoods form a canopy over his crowned head. His consort Lakshmi is massaging his right leg and two attendant figures stand behind her. Various gods and celestials are hovering above. In the lower panel, the two demons *Madhu* and *Kaitabha*, in an attacking attitude, are challenged by the four personified weapons of Vishnu.
- **Ganga and Yamuna, two life-sized terracotta images**, originally installed in niches flanking the main steps leading to the upper terrace of the **Shiva temple at Ahichhatra** belong to the Gupta period 4th century A.D. Ganga stands on her vehicle, the makara. and Yamuna on the cacchiap.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 42.C

- Mohiniyattam literally interpreted as the dance of '**Mohini**', the celestial enchantress of Hindu mythology, is the **classical solo dance form of Kerala**. Mohiniyattam as seen today has evolved through a long process of evolution. **It traces its origin to the temples of Kerala.**
- **Salient Features of Mohiniyattam Dance:**
 - Mohiniyattam is characterized by graceful, swaying body movements with no abrupt jerks or sudden leaps. It belongs to the lasya style which is feminine, tender, and graceful.
 - The movements are emphasized by the glides and the up and down movement on toes, like the waves of the sea and the swaying of the coconut, palm trees, and the paddy fields.
 - **The footwork is not terse and is rendered softly. Importance is given to the hand gestures and Mukhabhinaya with subtle facial expressions.**
 - Movements have been borrowed from Nangiar Koothu and female folk dances Kaikottikali and the Tiruvattirakali.

- Mohiniyattam lays emphasis on acting. The dancer identifies herself with the character and sentiments existing in the compositions like the Padams and Pada Varnams which give ample opportunity for facial expressions.
- The hand gestures, 24 in number, are mainly adopted from Hastalakshana Deepika, a text followed by Kathakali. Few are also borrowed from NatyaShastra, AbhinayaDarpana, and Balarambharatam.
- The gestures and facial expressions are closer to the natural (gramya) and the realistic (lokadharmi) than to the dramatic or rigidly conventional (natyadharmi).
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 43.D

- **Recently, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) issued an orange alert for Delhi.**
- Qualitatively, the heatwave is a condition of air temperature which becomes fatal to the human body when exposed. Quantitatively, it is defined based on the temperature thresholds over a region in terms of actual temperature or its departure from normal. In certain countries, it is defined in terms of the heat index based on temperature and humidity or based on the extreme percentile of the temperatures.
- A heatwave is considered if the maximum temperature of a station reaches at least 40 degrees celsius or more for Plains and at least 30 degrees celsius or more for Hilly regions. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- **Conditions for the heat waves are as follows:**
 - Transportation / Prevalence of hot dry air over a region (There should be a region of warm dry air and an appropriate flow pattern for transporting hot air over the region).
 - Absence of moisture in the upper atmosphere (As the presence of moisture restricts the temperature rise).
 - The sky should be practically cloudless (To allow maximum insulation over the region).
 - Large amplitude anti-cyclonic flow over the area.
- Heatwaves generally develop over Northwest India and spread gradually eastwards & southwards but not westwards (since the prevailing winds during the season are westerly to northwesterly). But on some occasions, heatwave may also develop over any region in situ under favorable conditions.
- The IMD uses four-color codes for weather warnings -- "green" (no action needed), "yellow" (watch and stay updated), "**orange**" (**be prepared**) and "red" (take action). **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 44.B

- **Statement 1 is not correct: Early Jain Tirthankar images and portraits of kings, are found at Mathura. Images of Vaishnava (mainly Vishnu and his various forms) and Shaiva (mainly the lingas and mukhalingas) faiths are also found at Mathura but Buddhist images are found in large numbers.** It may be noted that the images of Vishnu and Shiva are represented by their ayudhas (weapons).
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Kushans brought together masons and other artisans trained in different schools and countries. Indian craftsmen came in contact with the Greeks and the Romans, especially in the northwest frontier in Gandhara giving rise to the Gandhara school of art which had a strong Greco-Roman influence.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Gandhara art spread to many regions thereby influencing various local schools like Mathura and Sarnath. Mathura school produced many Buddha images but was also famous for the headless erect statue of Kanishka whose name is inscribed on its lower part.

Q 45.A

- Badami was the capital of the early Chalukyan dynasty which ruled the region from 543 to 598 CE. With the decline of the Vakataka rule, the Chalukyas established their power in the Deccan.
 - **The Chalukya king, Mangalesha, patronized the excavation of the Badami caves. He was the younger son of the Chalukya king, Pulakesin I, and the brother of Kirtivarman I.**
 - The inscription in Cave No.4 mentions the date 578–579 CE, describes the beauty of the cave, and includes the dedication of the image of Vishnu. Therefore, the cave is popularly known as the Vishnu Cave.
 - Paintings in this cave depict palace scenes. One shows Kirtivarman, the son of Pulakesin I and the elder brother of Mangalesha, seated inside the palace with his wife and feudatories watching a dance scene.

- Towards the corner of the panel are figures of Indra and his retinue. Stylistically speaking, the painting represents an extension of the tradition of mural painting from Ajanta to Badami in South India.
- The sinuously drawn lines, fluid forms, and compact composition exemplify the proficiency and maturity the artists had achieved in the sixth century CE.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 46.C

- **Statement 1 is correct: The shape of the main temple tower known as vimana in Tamil Nadu is like a stepped pyramid that rises up geometrically rather than the curving shikhara of North India.** In the South Indian temple, the word 'shikhara' is used only for the crowning element at the top of the temple which is usually shaped like a small stupa or an octagonal cupola— this is equivalent to the amlak and kalasha of North Indian temples.
- **Statement 2 is not correct: At the entrance to the North Indian temple's garbhagriha, it would be usual to find images such as mithunas and the river goddesses, Ganga and Yamuna, in the south you will generally find sculptures of fierce dvarapalas or the door-keepers guarding the temple.** It is common to find a large water reservoir, or a temple tank, enclosed within the complex in the Dravida style temple.
- **Statement 3 is correct: At some of the most sacred temples in South India, the main temple in which the garbhagriha is situated has, in fact, one of the smallest towers. This is because it is usually the oldest part of the temple.** With the passage of time, the population and size of the town associated with that temple would have increased, and it would have become necessary to make a new boundary wall around the temple. This would have been taller than the last one, and its gopurams would have been even loftier. So, for instance, the Srirangam temple in Tiruchirappalli has as many as seven 'concentric' rectangular enclosure walls, each with gopurams. The outermost is the newest, while the tower right in the center housing the garbhagriha is the oldest.

Q 47.A

- The rules and prescriptions regarding performance, the theatre hall, acting, gestures, Rasa, and stage direction are all given in the first book of dramaturgy, **Natyashastra, by Bharata (1st-century B.C.-1st century A.D.).**
- **The Mricchakatika (the clay-cart) by Sudraka (248 A.D.)** presents a remarkable social drama with touches of grim reality. The characters are drawn from all strata of society, which include thieves and gamblers, rogues and idlers, courtesans and their associates, police constables, mendicants, and politicians. In Act III an interesting account of a burglary is given in which stealing is treated as a regular art. The interlinking of a political revolution with the private affairs of the two lovers adds new charm to the play.
- **Bhavabhuti (700 A.D.),** another great dramatist, is well known for his **play Uttara-Ramacharitam** (the later life of Rama), which contains a play within it in the last act of a love of exquisite tenderness. He is also well known for directly rebuking his critics by saying that his work was not intended for them and that some kindred soul would surely be born; time is endless and the earth broad.
- **Jayadeva (12 century A.D.)** is the last great name in Sanskrit poetry, who wrote the lyric poetry **Gitagovinda** (the song of Govinda) to describe every phase of love between Krishna and Radha – longing, jealousy, hope, disappointment, anger, reconciliation and fruition – in picturesque lyrical language. The songs describe the beauty of nature, which plays a prominent part in the description of human love.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 48.C

- **Recently, the birth anniversary of B.R Ambedkar was celebrated.**
- To mobilize his followers he established organizations such as the **Bahishkrit Hitkarni Sabha, Independent Labour Party, and later All India Scheduled Caste Federation.**
- He led a number of temple-entry Satyagrahas, organized the untouchables, established many educational institutions, and propagated his views from newspapers like the '**Mooknayak**', and '**Bahishkrit Bharat**' and '**Janata**'.
- He participated in the Round Table Conference in order to protect the interests of the untouchables. He became the Chairman of the Drafting Committee of the Constituent Assembly and played a very important role in framing The Indian Constitution.

- He was also the Law Minister of India up to 1951.
- Right from 1935 Ambedkar was thinking of renouncing Hinduism. Finally, in 1956 he adopted Buddhism and appealed to his followers to do the same. He felt that the removal of untouchability and the spiritual upliftment of the untouchables would not be possible by remaining a Hindu. Hence, he embraced Buddhism.
- Ambedkar was not only a political leader and social reformer but also a scholar and thinker. He has written extensively on various social and political matters. '**Annihilation of Castes**', '**Who Were the Shudras**', '**The Untouchables**, and '**Buddha and His Dharma**' are his more important writings.
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 49.C

- Babur was deeply learned in Persian and Arabic, and is regarded as one of the two most famous writers in the Turkish language which was his mother tongue. His famous memoirs, the *Tuzuk-i-Baburi*, is considered one of the classics of world literature, written in the Turki language.
 - His other works include a masnavi and the Turkish translation of a well-known Sufi work.
- Babur is not the only Mughal emperor who wrote his auto-biography. **Mughal Emperor Jahangir also wrote his autobiography Tuzuk-e-Jahangiri in Persian Language. Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**
- An orthodox Sunni, **Babur was not bigoted or led by the religious divines.** At a time when there was a bitter sectarian feud between the Shias and the Sunnis in Iran and Turan, **his court was free from theological and sectarian conflicts.**
- Apparently, gunpowder was known in India but its use for artillery became common in north India with the advent of Babur. He **used it for the first time in his attacks on the fortress of Bhira (Gateway to Hindustan) in 1520-21.**
 - Though his reign was a period of war, only a few instances can be found of the destruction of temples. There is no evidence that the mosques built at Sambhal and Ayodhya by the local governors were built by breaking the Hindu temples there. Perhaps, they only repaired existing mosques, and put in an inscription in honor of Babur.
- **The battle of Khanwa (1527) was fought between Rana Sanga of Mewar and Mughal Emperor Babur after the Battle of Panipat. In the battle, Rana sangha was defeated.**
 - The battle of Khanwa secured Babur's position in the Delhi-Agra region. Babur strengthened his position further by conquering the chain of forts Gwaliyar, Dholpur, etc., east of Agra. He also annexed large parts of Alwar from Hasan Khan Mewati.

Q 50.C

- China, recently proposed a **Global Security Initiative**, at the Boao Forum in China, warning against "hegemonism, power politics and bloc confrontation".
- A new Global Security Initiative put forward by Chinese President Xi Jinping will look to counter the U.S. Indo-Pacific strategy and the Quad – the India, U.S., Australia, and Japan grouping.
- **Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 51.D

- Narasimhavarman I, also known as Mamalla, who acceded the Pallava throne around 640 CE, is celebrated for the expansion of the empire, avenging the defeat his father had suffered at the hands of Pulakesin II, and inaugurating most of the building works at Mahabalipuram which is known after him as Mamallapuram.
- **The shore temple at Mahabalipuram was built later, probably in the reign of Narasimhavarman II, also known as Rajasimha who reigned from 700 to 728 CE. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- It is oriented to the east-facing ocean, but if you study it closely, you will find that it actually houses **three shrines, two to Shiva**, one facing east and the other west, and a middle one to **Vishnu who is shown as Anantashayana**. This is unusual because temples generally have a single main shrine and not three areas of worship. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - This shows that it was probably not originally conceived like this and different shrines may have been added at different times, modified perhaps with the change of patrons.
- In the compound, there is evidence of a water tank, an early example of a gopuram, and several other images. Sculptures of the bull, Nandi, Shiva's mount, line the temple walls, and these, along with the carvings on the temple's lower walls have suffered severe disfiguration due to erosion by salt-water laden air over the centuries.

Q 52.D

- **Social Developments during the Gupta period:**
 - Large-scale land grants to the brahmanas suggest that the **brahmana supremacy increased in Gupta times**. The **Guptas, who probably were originally vaishyas, came to be looked upon as kshatriyas by the brahmanas**. The brahmanas presented the Gupta kings as possessing god-like attributes.
 - All this helped to legitimize the position of the Gupta princes, who became great supporters of the brahmanical order. The brahmanas accumulated wealth on account of the numerous land grants made to them and therefore claimed many privileges, which are listed in the Narada Smriti, the lawbook of Narada, a work of about the fifth century.
 - **The castes proliferated into numerous sub-castes** as a result of two factors. A **large number of foreigners had been assimilated into Indian society**, and each group of foreigners was considered a kind of caste. As the foreigners largely came as conquerors they were given the status of kshatriya in society.
 - ✓ **The Hunas**, who came to India towards the close of the fifth century, eventually came to be **recognized as one of the thirty-six clans of the Rajputs**. Even now some Rajputs bear the title Hun. The other reason for the increase in the number of castes was the absorption of many tribal people into brahmanical society through the process of land grants. **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**
 - The position of shudras improved during this period. They were now **permitted to listen to recitations of the Ramayana, the Mahabharata, and the Puranas**.
 - ✓ The epics and the Puranas represented the kshatriya tradition, whose myths and legends won loyalty to the social order. The **shudras could also worship a new god called Krishna** and were also permitted to perform certain domestic rites which naturally meant fees for the priests. This can all be linked to some improvement in the economic status of the shudras.
 - ✓ From the seventh century onwards, they were mainly represented as agriculturists; in the earlier period, they generally figured as servants, slaves, and agricultural labourers working for the three higher varnas. However, during this period, the **number of untouchables increased, especially the chandalas**. The chandalas entered the society as early as the fifth century BC.
 - In the Gupta period, like the shudras, women were also allowed to listen to the Ramayana, the Mahabharata, and the Puranas, and were advised to worship Krishna. However, **women of the higher orders did not have access to independent sources of livelihood** in pre-Gupta and Gupta times. The fact that **women of the two lower varnas were free to earn their livelihood, which gave them considerable freedom, but this was denied to women of the upper varnas**.
 - ✓ The first example of the immolation of a widow after the death of her husband occurred during the Gupta period during 510 AD but it was not rampant. However, some post-Gupta books held that a woman could remarry if her husband was dead, destroyed, impotent, had become a renouncer or had been excommunicated.
 - ✓ Widow remarriage was not allowed to members of the higher orders, but the shudras could practice widow remarriage.

Q 53.A

- Prehistoric paintings have been found in many parts of the world. We do not really know if Lower Palaeolithic people ever produced any art objects. But by the Upper Palaeolithic times, we see a proliferation of artistic activities. Around the world, the walls of many caves of this time are full of finely carved and painted pictures of animals that the cave-dwellers hunted. The subjects of their drawings were human figures, human activities, geometric designs, and animal symbols.
 - **In India, the earliest paintings have been reported from the Upper Palaeolithic times.**
- **The first discovery of rock paintings was made in India in 1867–68 by an archaeologist, Archibald Carlleyle, twelve years before the discovery of Altamira in Spain. Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
 - Cockburn, Anderson, Mitra, and Ghosh were the early archaeologists who discovered a large number of sites in the Indian sub-continent.
- Archibald Carlleyle discovered rock paintings at **Sohagihat in the Mirzapur district of Uttar Pradesh** in 1867 and 1868.
- In 1881 Cockburn had found fossilized rhinoceros bones in the valley of the Ken River in the Mirzapur region as well as a painting of a rhinoceros hunted by three men in a shelter near Roap Village. F Fawcett in the cave of Edakal in Kozhikode district of Kerala made the earliest discoveries of rock engravings. A few years later A Silberrad published a pictorial description of the rock paintings in the Banda district.
- C W Anderson discovered a painted shelter of Singhanpur in the Raigarh district in Madhya Pradesh.

Q 54.B

- The **string puppets of Odisha are known as Kundhei. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- The puppets are **made of light wood, and have no legs** but wear long flowing skirts. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- They have **more joints and are, therefore, more versatile, articulate, and easy to manipulate.** The puppeteers often hold a wooden prop, triangular in shape, to which strings are attached for manipulation.
- **The costumes of Kundhei resemble those worn by actors of the Jatra traditional theatre.** The music is drawn from the popular tunes of the region and is sometimes influenced by the music of Odisha dance.

Q 55.B

- **Recently, Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer Shah Faesal, who resigned from the service in protest against the “unabated” killings in Kashmir in 2019, has been reinstated.**
- A resignation is a formal intimation in writing by an officer of his/her intention or a proposal to leave the IAS, either immediately or at a specified date in the future. Guidelines of the Department of Personnel, the cadre controlling Department for the IAS, say that a resignation has to be clear and unconditional.
- **Resignation from service is entirely different from accepting the government’s Voluntary Retirement Scheme (VRS).** Those who take VRS are entitled to a pension, whereas those who resign are not. Rule 5 of the DCRB Rules says, “No retirement benefits may be granted to a person who has been dismissed or removed from the Service or who has resigned from the Service.” **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- **An officer serving in a cadre (state) must submit his/her resignation to the Chief Secretary of the state.** An officer who is on central deputation is required to submit his/her resignation to the secretary of the concerned Ministry or Department. The Ministry/Department then forwards the officer’s resignation to the concerned state cadre, along with its comments or recommendations. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- Rule 5(1A)(i) of the amended DCRB Rules says **the central government may permit an officer to withdraw his/her resignation “in the public interest”.** An amendment in the Rules in 2011 states “that the period of absence from duty between the date on which the resignation became effective and the date on which the member is allowed to resume duty as a result of permission to withdraw the resignation is not more than ninety days”. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Q 56.C

- The **Gupta rulers gave patronage to Bhagvatism.** But they were **tolerant of other religions** too. The Chinese pilgrim Fa Hien and Hsuan Tsang, who came to India during the reign of Chandragupta II and Harsha respectively, clearly give the impression that **Buddhism was also flourishing. Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- Harsha, though a Shaiva in his early life, became a follower of Buddhism and a great patron of the religion. He convened an assembly at Kanauj to publicize Mahayanaism. **Nalanda developed as a great center of education for Mahayana Buddhism** during his time. Students from outside countries also came to study at this university.
- According to Hsuan Tsang, the revenues of one hundred villages supported it. **Bhagvatism centered on the worship of Vishnu and his incarnations.** It emphasized bhakti (loving devotion) and ahimsa (non-killing of animals) rather than Vedic rituals and sacrifices. The new religion was quite liberal and assimilated the lower classes into its fold. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- According to Bhagavadgita, the chief text of Bhagvatism, whenever there was a social crisis Vishnu would appear in a human form and save the people. Thus ten incarnations of Vishnu were perceived. **Puranas were written to popularize the virtues of each one of these incarnations.** The idols of gods were housed in the temples constructed in the Gupta period.
- From the fifth century the Brahmanas had started receiving land in the tribal areas of Nepal, Assam, Bengal, Orissa, Central India, and Deccan. As a consequence, the tribal elements came to be assimilated into the Brahmanical society. The Brahmanas adopted their rituals, gods, and goddesses. It is this **assimilation of Brahmanical religion and tribal practices that resulted in the development of Tantrism.**
- It did not believe in any caste or gender bias and admitted both women and Shudras in its ranks. It emphasized **‘female’ as a source of power and energy.** The Tantrik concepts affected, Shaivism and Vaishnavism as well as Buddhism and Jainism. It resulted in the **introduction of the worship of female deities in these religions. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Q 57.D

- **Cultural consequences of contact of Central Asian powers over India:**
 - **Better Cavalry:** The Shakas and Kushans added new ingredients to Indian culture and enriched it immensely. They settled in India for good and completely identified themselves with its culture. As they did not have their own script, written language, or any organized religion, they adopted these components of culture from India and became an integral part of Indian society to which they contributed considerably.
 - ✓ **They introduced better cavalry and the use of riding horse on a large scale.** They popularized the use of reins and saddles, which appear in the Buddhist sculpture of the second and third centuries AD. **The Shakas and the Kushans were excellent horsemen.**
 - ✓ Their passion for horsemanship is shown by numerous equestrian terracotta figures of **Kushan times discovered from Begram in Afghanistan.** Some of these foreign horsemen were heavily armoured and fought with spears and lances. Presumably, they also used some form of toe stirrup made of rope which facilitated their movements.
 - **Trade:** The coming of the Central Asian people established intimate contacts between Central Asia and India. **India received a great fund of gold** from the Altai mountains in Central Asia. **Gold may also have been received by it through trade with the Roman empire.**
 - ✓ **The Kushans controlled the Silk Route**, which started from China and passed through their empire in Central Asia and Afghanistan to Iran, and western Asia which formed part of the Roman empire in the eastern Mediterranean zone.
 - ✓ This route was a **source of substantial income for the Kushans, and they built a large prosperous empire on the strength of the tolls levied from traders.** It is significant that the Kushans were the first rulers in India to issue gold coins on a wide scale.
 - **Emergence of Mahayana Buddhism:** Indian religions underwent changes in post-Maurya times partly due to a great leap in trade and artisanal activity and partly due to the large influx of people from Central Asia. Buddhism was especially affected. The monks and nuns could not afford to lose the cash donations from the growing body of traders and artisans concentrated in towns. **Large numbers of coins are found in the monastic areas of Nagarjunakonda in AP.**
 - ✓ Also, the Buddhists welcomed foreigners who were non-vegetarians. All this meant laxity in the day-to-day living of the nuns and monks who led an austere life. They now accepted gold and silver, took to non-vegetarian food, and wore elaborate robes. Discipline became so lax that some renunciates even deserted the religious order or the sangha and resumed the householder's life.
 - ✓ This **new form of Buddhism came to be called Mahayana or the Great Vehicle.** In the old puritan Buddhism, certain things associated with the Buddha were worshipped as his symbols. These were replaced with his images at the time when the Christian era began. **Image worship started with Buddhism** but was followed on a large scale in Brahmanism. With the rise of Mahayana the old puritan school of Buddhism came to be known as the Hinayana or the Lesser Vehicle.
 - **Political administration:** The **Kushans strengthened the satrap system of government adopted by the Shakas.** The empire was divided into numerous satrapies, and each was placed under the rule of a satrap. Some curious practices such as hereditary dual rule, that is, two kings ruling in the same kingdom simultaneously, were begun, with instances of father and son ruling jointly at the same time. **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**
 - ✓ It thus appears that **there was less of centralization** under these rulers. The **Greeks also introduced the practice of military governorship, the governors called strategos.** Military governors were necessary to maintain the power of the new rulers over the conquered people.

Q 58.D

- The Lion Capital discovered more than a hundred years ago at Sarnath, near Varanasi, is generally referred to as Sarnath Lion Capital. This is one of the finest examples of sculpture from the Mauryan period.
- Built-in commemoration of the historical event of the first sermon or the Dhammachakrapravartana by the Buddha at Sarnath, the capital was built by Ashoka.
- The capital originally consisted of five component parts:
 - **the shaft (which is broken in many parts now),**
 - **a lotus bell base,**
 - **a drum on the bell base with four animals proceeding clockwise,**
 - the figures of four majestic addorsed lions, and
 - **the crowning element, Dharmachakra, a large wheel, was also a part of this pillar.** However, this wheel is lying in a broken condition and is displayed in the site museum at Sarnath.

- The capital without the crowning wheel, shaft, and the lotus base has been adopted as the National Emblem of Independent India.
- Hence option (d) is the correct answer.

Q 59.B

- The traditions and religious practices of the Indus Valley Civilization survived even after its decline and became an integral part of the Indian Civilization. The knowledge about the religious practices and beliefs of the Indus Valley people is derived from the archaeological findings at various sites.
 - The Indus valley sites have yielded **terracotta figurines of women**, heavily jewelled, some with elaborate headdresses. These were regarded as **mother goddesses**. The **Pashupati seal** from Mohenjo-Daro demonstrates a deity sitting in a yogic posture. This gives evidence of **Image worship** in the Indus Valley Civilization.
 - The structure of the **Great Bath found at Mohenjo-Daro** indicates a **tradition of ritual bathing**. Ritual bathing has been an integral part of the Indian Civilization.
 - The **evidence of tree worship** and animal worship has been found in the numerous seals. The Harappan seals, sealings, amulets, and copper tablets depict a number of trees, plants, and animals, some of which have had religious significance. The pipal (*Ficus religiosa*) tree appears often on the seals which indicate tree worship in the Indus Valley.
 - The **tradition of temple worship did not exist** in the Indus Valley Civilization as no temples have been discovered. Not a single structure found at any Harappan site can conclusively be identified as a temple.
- Hence option (b) is the correct answer.

Q 60.A

- **Recently, Germany, France, and other countries have accused Russia of war crimes in the town of Bucha just outside Ukraine's capital Kyiv.**
- International Criminal Court is governed by an international treaty called 'The Rome Statute'. It is the world's first permanent international criminal court. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **ICC headquarters at the Hague, the Netherlands. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- It investigates and where warranted, tries individuals charged with the gravest crimes of concern to the international community like genocide, war crimes, crimes against humanity, and the crime of aggression.
- **United Nations Security Council (UNSC) can also refer cases to ICC** pursuant to a resolution adopted under Chapter VII of the UN charter.
- **ICC is not a UN organization** but it has a cooperation agreement with the United Nations.
- **India has neither signed nor ratified the Rome Statute. Many major countries, among them, constituting the majority of the world's population, did not sign the Rome Statute, including the United States, Russia, China, India, Russia, Ukraine, and Indonesia.** But Ukraine has given its approval to examine alleged atrocities on its territory dating back to Russia's annexation of Crimea in 2014. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
- **Many Islamic countries, including Pakistan. 111 states have currently ratified the 1998 Rome Statutes, which entered into force on July 1, 2002, after ratification by 60 countries.**
- **ICC judgments are binding, final, and cannot be appealed.**

Q 61.C

- **Kornish** was a form of **ceremonial salutation** in which the courtier placed the palm of his right hand against his forehead and bent his head. It suggested that the subject placed his head – the seat of the senses and the mind – into the hand of humility, presenting it to the royal assembly.
- **Chahar taslim** is a mode of salutation which begins with placing the back of the right hand on the ground, and raising it gently till the person stands erect, when he puts the palm of his hand upon the crown of his head. It is done four (chahar) times. Taslim literally means submission.
- **Sijda is also called Zaminbos.** It is a form of respect paid to the Emperor or high authority or Divine persona. The person doing sijda performs it by touching the ground with the forehead as act of adoration or worship to God.
- Hence option (c) is the correct answer.

Q 62.C

- **The art of bronze-casting was practiced on a wide scale by the Harappans. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - Their bronze statues were made using the 'lost wax technique.'
 - In bronze, we find human as well as animal figures, the best example of the former being the statue of a girl popularly titled 'Dancing Girl'. Amongst animal figures in bronze the buffalo with its uplifted head, back, and sweeping horns and the goat is of artistic merit.
 - **Bronze casting was popular at all the major centers of the Indus Valley Civilisation.** The copper dog and bird of Lothal and the bronze figure of a bull from Kalibangan are in no way inferior to the human figures of copper and bronze from Harappa and Mohenjodaro.
- Archaeologists have discovered thousands of seals, mostly made of steatite, and occasionally of agate, chert, copper, faience, and terracotta, with beautiful figures of animals, such as unicorn bull, rhinoceros, tiger, elephant, bison, goat, buffalo, etc.
 - **The purpose of producing seals was mainly commercial.** It appears that the seals were also used as amulets, carried on the persons of their owners, perhaps as modern-day identity cards.
 - The standard Harappan seal was a square plaque 2×2 square inches, made from steatite. **Every seal is engraved in a pictographic script that is yet to be deciphered. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - **Some seals have also been found in ivory.**
- **A large quantity of pottery excavated from the sites,** enables us to understand the gradual evolution of various design motifs as employed in different shapes, and styles.
 - The Indus Valley pottery consists chiefly of very fine wheel-made wares, very few being hand-made.
 - Plain pottery is more common than painted ware. Plain pottery is generally of red clay, with or without a fine red or grey slip. It includes knobbed ware, ornamented with rows of knobs.
 - The black painted ware has a fine coating of red slip-on which geometric and animal designs are executed in glossy black paint.
 - **Polychrome pottery is rare** and mainly comprises small vases decorated with geometric patterns in red, black, and green, rarely white and yellow. **Incised ware is also rare** and the incised decoration was confined to the bases of the pans, always inside and to the dishes of offering stands. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
 - Perforated pottery includes a large hole at the bottom and small holes all over the wall, and was probably used for straining beverages.
 - Pottery for household purposes is found in as many shapes and sizes as could be conceived of for daily practical use. Straight and angular shapes are an exception, while graceful curves are the rule.

Q 63.B

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Karaikkal Ammaiyar was a great devotee of **Lord Shiva**.
- **Statement 2 is correct: Karaikkal Ammaiyar followed the course of intense asceticism to gain her goal.** She is one of the three women saints among the 63 Nayanars and is considered one of the greatest figures of Tamil literature. Her compositions were preserved within the Nayanar tradition.

Q 64.B

- The age of Mahajanpadas (sixth century B.C.) was characterized by the use of Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW). NBPW was a very glossy, shining type of pottery. The archaeological excavations at NBPW sites give a picture of contemporary material culture.
 - The NBPW phase saw the **beginning of metallic money. Punched marked coins of silver** were used in Trade & commerce. The use of burnt bricks and ring wells appeared in the middle of the NBPW phase, i.e., in the third century B.C. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - The **NBPW phase marked the beginning of the second urbanization** in India. The Indus Valley Civilization (2600-1800 B.C.) first saw the emergence of towns/cities in India. The Harappan towns finally disappeared in about 1500 B.C. After that, for about 1,000 years we did not find any towns in India. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - During this phase, the artisans and merchants were organized into guilds termed **Nigama**. Such organizations led to the **specialization of art and craft activities. Hence statement 3 is correct.**
 - In the social sphere, the NBPW phase was marked by the emergence of new social classes. This included merchants (Sethis), **Gahapatis (rich peasants)** and Karmakaras (wage labourers), etc.

Q 65.A

- **Cabinet has recently approved 3 important Umbrella Schemes of the Ministry to be implemented in mission mode, viz., Mission Poshan 2.0, Mission Shakti, and Mission Vatsalya.**
- **Mission Vatsalya**, which has been operationalized, is one of the new triads of schemes along with Mission Shakti, and Poshan 2.0, that aims at **securing a healthy and happy childhood for every child.**
- Components under Mission Vatsalya include statutory bodies; service delivery structures; institutional care/services; non-institutional community-based care; emergency outreach services; training and capacity building.
- The impact of this on one of the pillars of India's child protection services, the ChildLine, has been giving child rights activists sleepless nights. ChildLine (1098), the 24-hour toll-free helpline for children in distress, will be manned by the Home Affairs Ministry under Mission Vatsalya.
- **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 66.D

- The Samkhya School of Philosophy is perhaps the **oldest of the six systems**, being mentioned in the Bhagavad Gita and occurring in a primitive form in the Upanisads. **Kapila is described as the legendary founder of the school.**
- Samkhya has a detailed ontology (a theory of being) and epistemology. It holds that the world we see around us really exists.
- **Two fundamental categories in Samkhya thought are purusha (the spiritual principle) and prakriti (matter or nature). There are supposed to be many purushas, all of them eternal, unchanging, passive, and conscious witnesses.**
- Prakriti, on the other hand, is eternal and unchanging, but also active and unconscious. It has three gunas or qualities—sattva (goodness), rajas (energy or passion), and tamas (darkness or inertia).
- **According to early Samkhya philosophy the presence of divine agency is not essential to the creation of the world.** The world owes its creation and evolution more to Nature or Prakriti than to God. This was a rational and scientific view. Around the fourth century A.D. in addition to Prakriti, Purusha or spirit was introduced as an element in its system, and the creation of the world was attributed to both. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- In the beginning, the Samkhya school of philosophy was materialistic. Then it tended to be spiritualistic. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- **Liberation consists of the purusha realizing its distinction from prakriti. A person can attain salvation through the acquisition of real knowledge, and his misery can be ended forever. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The Samkhya system also talks of other categories such as buddhi (will and the discriminating faculty), ahamkara (I-ness, the ego), and mind. Samkhya considers perception and reliable testimony as valid bases of knowledge and attaches a great deal of importance to inference.

Q 67.C

- **Recently, a self-amplifying mRNA vaccine — one in which the delivered RNA multiplies inside the body — has shown promising results against Covid-19 in ongoing phase 1/2/3 trials.**
- These vaccines promise the flexibility of plasmid DNA vaccines with enhanced immunogenicity and safety. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- A self-amplifying mRNA vaccine is an improvement on the traditional RNA platform.
- It encodes four extra proteins in addition to the vaccine antigen, and these enable amplification of the original strand of RNA once inside the cell.
- The basic advantage is that it requires a smaller dose. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 68.B

- **Folk Dances of India:**
 - **Giddha** is performed by women in **Punjab. Hence pair 2 is correctly matched.**
 - **In the fishing communities of Maharashtra**, men and women link arms and dance together and the women climb onto the men's shoulders to form pyramids. The women's **Lavani dance** from this area is notable for its unabashed sensuality. **Hence pair 1 is not correctly matched.**
 - There are also several forms of dance-drama or folk theatre, such as the **Nautanki of Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, and Bihar, the Bhavai of Gujarat, the irreverent Tamasha of Maharashtra, the Bengali Jatra, the spectacular Yakshagana of Karnataka and Theyyam of Kerala, all of which narrate legends of local heroes, kings, and deities. Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**

Q 69.A

- The **Rig Vedic society** (1500 B.C. to 1000 B.C) was **pastoral, cattle rearing** being the **dominant occupational activity**. A **pastoral society relies more on its animal wealth than on agricultural produce**. Thus, Cattle rearing rather than agriculture was of overwhelming importance during this period. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
 - **Agriculture was the chief means of subsistence of the later Vedic people.** Late Vedic texts speak of six, eight, twelve and even twenty-four oxen yoked to the plough.
- The most important divinity in the Rig Veda is Indra, who is called Purandara or destroyer of dwelling units. Indra played the role of a warlord, leading the Aryan soldiers to victory against the demons, and has 250 hymns devoted to him. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
 - The second position is held by Agni (Fire God) to whom 200 hymns are devoted. In Vedic times, Agni acted as a kind of intermediary between the gods, on the one hand, and people on the other.
- **In the post-Rig Vedic times, two other collections, the Yajur Veda Samhita and Atharva Veda Samhita were composed. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - The Yajur Veda contains not only hymns but also rituals to accompany their recitation, the latter reflecting the social and political milieu of the time.
 - The Atharva Veda contains charms and spells to ward off evils and diseases, its contents throwing light on the beliefs and practices of the non-Aryans.

Q 70.D

- In the early years of Muhammad bin Tughlaq's reign, the Mongols under their leader Tarmashrin burst into Sind, and a force reached up to Meerut, about 65 km from Delhi. Muhammad Tughlaq not only defeated the Mongols in a battle near the Jhelum, but also occupied Kalanaur and for some time his power extended beyond the Indus up to Peshawar.
- In 1334, **Ibn Battuta** arrived in India all the way through the mountains of Afghanistan, during the time when the Tughlaq dynasty was at its height. In the memories of the Tughlaq dynasty, Ibn Battuta studied and wrote about the history of the famous Qutb complex, and also about Quwat al-Islam Mosque, and last but not least about the famous Qutb Minar.
- Muhammad Tughlaq launched a scheme to extend and improve cultivation in the doab. He **set up a separate department called diwan-i-amir-i-kohi**. The area was divided into development blocs headed by an official whose job was to extend cultivation by giving loans to the cultivators and to induce them to cultivate superior crops—wheat in place of barley, sugarcane in place of wheat, grapes and dates in place of sugarcane, etc.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 71.B

- **Recently, rapid, uncontrollable invasion of senna spectabilis is hitting the carrying capacity of forests in Kerala to feed wildlife.**
- Senna spectabilis belongs to Fabaceae family, and is grown as ornamental plant across tropical America. It can grow 7-18 meters tall; is evergreen in climates with rain all year round, but can become deciduous in some regions, and produces yellow flowers. Spectabilis has been commonly used in traditional medicine for many years.
- It is an **invasive plant** in the forest areas of the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve (NBR), including the Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary.
- **Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 72.C

- **Statement 1 is correct:** One of the greatest rulers of Kashmir was Zainul Abidin (1420–1470). He was an enlightened ruler and called back those Hindus who had left the state due to the persecution of Sikandar Shah. **He abolished jizya and prohibited cow slaughter** and gave the Hindus important state posts. A large number of temples were repaired and new ones constructed.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** He was a great scholar of Persian, Sanskrit, Tibetan and Arab languages and patronized the Sanskrit and Persian scholars. Under his patronage, **Mahabharat** and Kalhana's **Rajatarangini** were translated into Persian and many Persian and Arabic works were translated into Hindi. He himself was a poet and wrote poetry under the pen name '**Qutb**'.
- The sultan developed agriculture by making large numbers of dams, canals and bridges. He was an enthusiastic builder, his greatest engineering achievement being Zaina Lanka—the artificial island in the Woollur Lake on which he built his palace and a mosque.

Q 73.A

- **Panini** was a grammarian who lived in the **5th or 4th century BCE**. He composed **Ashtadhyayi**, which is the **oldest surviving Sanskrit grammar**. It represents a brilliant intellectual achievement. It sums up the rules of Sanskrit grammar in 3,996 aphorisms (sutras)— short, highly compressed, and condensed statements—combining brevity with clarity and comprehensive coverage. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **Aryabhatta (AD 476-500)** and **Varahamihra (6th century AD)** contributed to the development of mathematics and astronomy in ancient India.
- They **were much younger than Panini** who belonged to the 5th or 4th century BCE.
- Thus Panin's work was not influenced by Aryabhatta and Varahamihra. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 74.A

- **Bhand Pather:**
 - **The traditional theatre form of Kashmir** is a unique combination of dance, music, and acting. Satire, wit, and parody are preferred for inducing laughter. **Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
 - In this theatre form, music is provided with surnai, nagaara, and dhol. Since the actors of Bhand Pather are mainly from the farming community, the impact of their way of living, ideals, and sensitivity is discernible.
- **Maach:**
 - It is the traditional **theatre form of Madhya Pradesh**. The term Maach is used for the stage itself as also for the play. In this theatre, form songs are given prominence in between the dialogues. **Hence pair 2 is not correctly matched.**
 - The term for dialogue in this form is bol and rhyme in narration is termed vanag. The tunes of this theatre form are known as rangat.
- **Bhaona:**
 - **It is a presentation of the Ankia Naat of Assam.** **Hence pair 3 is not correctly matched.**
 - In Bhaona cultural glimpses of Assam, Bengal Orissa, Mathura and Brindavan can be seen. The Sutradhaar or narrator begins the story, first in Sanskrit and then in either Brajboli or Assamese.

Q 75.B

- The **Razmnama (Book of War)**, the first-ever Persian translation of the Mahabharata was commissioned by Mughal emperor Akbar in 1582. His court historian Abdul Qadir Badauni records that it took nearly four years to compile four lavishly bound volumes of the book.
- It had 168 album bound paintings and 707 folios. Badauni recounts that Akbar chose the Mahabharata because "This is the most famous of the Hindu books and contains all sorts of stories and moral reflections, and advice, and matters relating to conduct and manners and religion and science". It was an initiative to preserve the unity of his empire and win over the non-Muslim population. **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 76.A

- The Indian stone age is divided into the Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, and Neolithic on the basis of geological age, the type and technology of stone tools, and subsistence base. The Palaeolithic age is further divided into the lower, middle, and upper Palaeolithic.
- **Hunting and gathering were the subsistence basis of the Paleolithic age and man had no knowledge of cultivation.** The cultivation of crops began during the Neolithic age. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- In 9000 BC began an intermediate stage in Stone-age culture, which is called the Mesolithic age. It intervened as a transitional phase between the Paleolithic and Neolithic age.
 - The people of this age lived on hunting, fishing and food gathering initially **but later on they also domesticated animals** and cultivated plants, thereby paving the way for agriculture. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 77.D

- After the break-up of the Maurya empire, the **Satavahanas and Kushans emerged** as the two large powers. The Satavahanas acted as a stabilizing factor in the Deccan and the south to which they provided political unity and economic prosperity on the strength of their trade with the Roman empire.
 - The Kushans performed the same role in the north. Both these empires came to an end in the mid-third century.

- **On the ruins of the Kushan empire** arose a new empire that established its sway over a substantial part of the former dominions of the Kushans. This was the empire of the Guptas, who may have been of vaishya origin. The **Guptas were possibly feudatories of the Kushans in UP**, and seem to have succeeded them without any considerable time-lag.
- **Samudragupta (AD 335–80):** The Gupta kingdom was enlarged enormously by Chandragupta's son and successor Samudragupta (AD 335–80). **He was the opposite of Ashoka. Ashoka believed in a policy of peace and non-aggression, but Samudragupta delighted in violence and conquest. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
 - His **court poet Harishena** wrote a glowing account of the military exploits of his patron, and, in a long inscription, the poet enumerates the peoples and countries that were conquered by Samudragupta. **The inscription is engraved at Allahabad on the same pillar that carries the inscriptions of the peace-loving Ashoka.**
 - This was granted, and the temple was developed into a huge monastic establishment. If we are to believe the eulogistic inscription at Allahabad, it would appear that **Samudragupta never knew defeat, and because of his bravery and generalship, he is called the Napoleon of India.**
- **Chandragupta II (AD 380–412):** The **reign of Chandragupta II saw the high watermark of the Gupta empire.** He extended the limits of the empire by marriage alliance and conquest. Chandragupta married his daughter Prabhavati to a Vakataka prince of the brahmana caste and ruled in central India. The prince died and was succeeded by his young son. Prabhavati thus became the virtual ruler.
 - However, the epigraphic eulogy seems to be exaggerated. **Chandragupta II adopted the title of Vikramaditya, which had been first used by a Ujjain ruler in 58–57 BC as a mark of victory over the Shaka Kshatrapas of western India. This Ujjain ruler is traditionally called Shakari or the enemy of the Shakas.** The Vikrama samvat or era was started in 58–57 BC by Shakari. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 78.A

- From the early centuries of the Common Era, we find grants of land being made, many of which were recorded in inscriptions.
- Some of these inscriptions were on stone, but most were on copper plates which were probably given as a record of the transaction to those who received the land. The records that have survived are generally about grants to religious institutions or to Brahmanas.
- **An agrahara** was land granted to a Brahmana, who was usually exempted from paying land revenue and other dues to the king and was often given the right to collect these dues from the local people. **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 79.C

- **Tazkiras** are the **biographical accounts of saints.** The 14th century Siyar-ul-Auliya of Mir Khwurd Kirmani was the first sufi tazkira written in India. It dealt principally with the Chishti saints. **Hence pair 1 is not correctly matched.**
- **Maktubats** are the **collection of letters written by sufi masters**, addressed to their disciples and associates. They reflect the life conditions of the recipients and are responses to their aspirations and difficulties, both spiritual and mundane. **Hence pair 2 is not correctly matched.**
- **Malfuzats** are the **texts containing the conversations of sufi saints.** An early text on malfuzat is the Fawa'id-al-Fu'ad, a collection of conversations of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya, compiled by Amir Hasan Sijzi Dehlavi, a noted Persian poet. **Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**

Q 80.D

- The archaeological findings at the Indus Valley sites indicate **a tradition of burying the dead bodies in pits.** The dead bodies in some cases were buried along with the pottery and ornaments indicating a belief that these could be used in the afterlife.
- The Indus Valley people had established trade relations with the contemporary Mesopotamians. **The Mesopotamian literature refers to trade with a region called Meluha** which is identified with the region occupied by the Indus Valley civilization. These texts mention the products from Meluhha: carnelian, lapis lazuli, copper, gold, and varieties of wood.
- The Indus valley people used a **standard system of weights and measures.** The lower denominations of weights were binary (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, etc. up to 12,800), while the **higher denominations followed the decimal system.** The weights were made of stone called chert.

- The **Indus Valley people were aware of gold and gold ornaments have been discovered** at the Indus Valley sites. It is believed that the gold was procured from the south. **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 81.A

- Ramananda was a **14th-century Vaishnava poet, born at Prayag (Allahabad) and lived there and at Banaras.** He was a follower of Ramanuja:
 - **Statement 1 is correct:** He substituted the worship of Rama in place of Vishnu. He taught his doctrine of Bhakti to all the four varnas, and enrolled disciples from all castes, including the low castes.
 - **Statement 2 is not correct: Kabir was a 15th-century Indian mystic poet and saint, whose writings influenced Hinduism's Bhakti movement. He was a disciple of Swami Ramananda in Varanasi and was strongly influenced by his writings.** He is known for devotional Vaishnavism with a strong inclination towards monism Advaita philosophy teaching which says God was inside every person and everything.
 - ✓ Ramananda taught his doctrine of Bhakti to all the four varnas and disregarded the ban on people of different castes cooking together and sharing their meals. He enrolled disciples from all castes, including the low castes. Thus, among his disciples was Ravidas, who was a cobbler by caste; **Kabir, who was a weaver**; Sena, who was a barber; and Sadhana, who was a butcher. Namadeva was equally broad-minded in enrolling his disciples.

Q 82.C

- During the second millennium B.C. several regional cultures sprang up in different parts of the Indian subcontinent. These were non-urban, non-Harappan and were characterized by the use of stone and copper tools. Hence, these cultures are termed chalcolithic cultures. The chalcolithic cultures are identified on the basis of their geographical location.
 - The **Jorwe culture** is the most important and characteristic chalcolithic culture of **Maharashtra**, extending almost all over the present state, excepting the coastal strip on the west and Vidarbha in the northeast. The culture is named after the type site of Jorwe in the Ahmednagar district, of Maharashtra. **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**
 - **Kayatha culture** was named after the type site **Kayatha, in the Ujjain district of Madhya Pradesh.** Over forty settlements of the Kayatha culture have been so far discovered in the Malwa region of Madhya Pradesh, most of them being located on the tributaries of the Chambal River.
 - **The Ahar culture** is among the earliest Chalcolithic cultures of India. This is seen from the calibrated radio-carbon dates available from many of the sites. The culture has been named after the **type site Ahar, in District Udaipur, Rajasthan.**

Q 83.D

- In the age of Buddha, there were 16 large states called Mahajanapadas. They were mostly situated north of the Vindhya and extended from the north-west frontier to Bihar.
- Anga kingdom comprised the districts of Bhagalpur and Monghyr in Bihar. It was located to the east of Magadha and west of the Rajmahal hills. **Champa was the capital of Anga.**
 - In the middle of the sixth century B.C. Anga was annexed by Magadha
- Kosala embraced the area occupied by eastern Uttar Pradesh and **had its capital at Shravasti.**
 - Kosala became a prosperous Kingdom having three big cities under its control i.e. Ayodhya. Saketa and Shravasti.
 - Kosala also included the tribal republican territory of Sakyas of Kapilavastu, the birthplace of Buddha.
- Further west lay the kingdom of the Vastus, along the bank of river Yamuna, with its **capital at Kaushambi.** The Vastus were a Kuru clan who had shifted from Hastinapur and settled down at Kaushambi near Allahabad.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 84.A

- Peasants formed the overwhelming majority of the population in medieval India. It was, however, not a homogenous group. One end of the spectrum was represented by rich peasants (khuts & muqaddams during Delhi Sultanate and khudkasht during the Mughal period), having large holdings and cultivated their lands with the help of hired labour.

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Khudkashts** were the rich/prosperous peasants who owned tracts of land and tools of agriculture.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** They paid land revenue at customary rates. Some of them had many ploughs and bullocks which they let out to their poorer brethren, the tenants or **muzarian** who generally paid land revenue at a higher rate. These two groups were the largest section among the cultivators in the village.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** The khudkasht who claimed to be the original settlers of the village often belonged to a single dominant caste or castes. These castes not only dominated the village society, they exploited the other or weaker sections. In turn, they were often exploited by the zamindars.
 - **Muzarian** belonged to the same village but did not have either land or implements and hence were dependent on the Khud-kasht for their supply.

Q 85.B

- **Fatehpur Sikri, a city predominantly in red sandstone at Agra, was built by the Mughal Emperor Jalal-ud-din Mohammad Akbar, in honor of the great Sufi saint Sheikh Salim Chisti. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
 - He had planned this city as his capital but a shortage of water compelled him to abandon the city. After this within 20 years, the capital of Mughals was shifted to Lahore. Fatehpur Sikri was built between 1571 and 1585.
 - The city was originally rectangular in plan, with a grid pattern of roads and by-lanes which cut at right angles, and featured efficient drainage and water management system.
 - **The buildings are constructed in red sandstone with little use of marble.**
 - ✓ **Diwan-i-Am (Hall of Public Audience)** is encircled by a series of porticos broken up at the west by the insertion of the emperor's seat in the form of a small raised chamber separated by perforated stone screens and provided with a pitched stone roof. This chamber communicates directly with the imperial palace complex clustered along with a vast court.
 - ✓ On the north side of it stands a building popularly known as **Diwan-i-Khas (Hall of Private Audience)**, also known as the 'Jewel House'.
 - ✓ Other monuments of exceptional quality are **Panch Mahal**, an extraordinary, entirely columnar five-story structure disposed asymmetrically on the pattern of a Persian badgir, or wind-catcher tower; **the pavilion of Turkish Sultana; Anup Talao** (Peerless Pool); **Diwan-Khana-i-Khas and Khwabgah (Sleeping Chamber); palace of Jodha Bai**, the largest building of the residential complex, which has richly carved interior pillars, balconies, perforated stone windows, and an azure-blue ribbed roof on the north and south sides; **Birbal's House; and the Caravan Sarai, Haram Sara, baths, waterworks, stables, and Hiran tower.**
 - ✓ Architecturally, the buildings are a beautiful amalgamation of indigenous and Persian styles.
 - ✓ **Amongst the religious monuments at Fatehpur Sikri, Jama Masjid is the earliest building constructed on the summit of the ridge**, completed in 1571-72. This mosque incorporates the **tomb of Shaikh Salim Chisti (the only building at Fatehpur Sikri built of white marble)**. It is a square chamber, having a screened verandah, containing latticed panels of exquisite design, and is an elegant structure
 - ✓ To the south of the court is an imposing structure, **Buland Darwaza (Lofty Gate)**, with a height of 40 m, erected in 1601-02 AD to commemorate Akbar's victory over Gujarat. Hence statement 2 is correct.

Q 86.D

- **The All-India Household Consumer Expenditure Survey, usually conducted by the National Statistical Office (NSO) every five years, is set to resume in 2022 after a prolonged break.**
- **The National Statistical Office (NSO), Ministry of Statistics, and Programme Implementation** conducts the all-India survey on household consumption expenditure. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The Consumer Expenditure Survey (CES) is usually conducted at **quinquennial intervals (after every 5 years).**
- The NSS Consumer Expenditure Survey generates estimates of household Monthly Per Capita Consumer Expenditure (MPCE) and the distribution of households and persons over the MPCE classes.
- It is designed to collect information regarding expenditure on **consumption of goods and services (food and non-food)** consumed by households. The results, after release, are also used for rebasing the GDP and other macroeconomic indicators. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 87.D

- **Recently, after Meghalaya, Assam is now focusing on the border dispute with neighbor Arunachal Pradesh.**
- Arunachal Pradesh shares its border with **Assam and Nagaland. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- Meghalaya is bound to the south by the Bangladeshi divisions of Mymensingh and Sylhet, to the west by the Bangladeshi division of Rangpur, and to the north and east by **India's State of Assam. Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- Sikkim borders the Tibet Autonomous Region of China in the north and northeast, Bhutan in the east, Province No. 1 of Nepal in the west, and **West Bengal** (not Assam) in the south. Sikkim is also close to the Siliguri Corridor, which borders Bangladesh. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**



Q 88.A

- **The fourth '2+2' dialogue between India and the United States was recently held.**
- **The 2+2 dialogue is a format of the meeting of the foreign and defense ministers of India and its allies on strategic and security issues.** A 2+2 ministerial dialogue enables the partners to better understand and appreciate each other's strategic concerns and sensitivities taking into account political factors on both sides, in order to build a stronger, more integrated strategic relationship in a rapidly changing global environment. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- India has 2+2 dialogues with four key strategic partners: the **US, Australia, Japan, and Russia.** Besides Russia, the other three countries are also India's partners in the Quad. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 89.C

- Probably the greatest Rashtrakuta rulers were Govinda III (793–814) and Amoghavarsha I (814–878). After a successful expedition against Nagabhata of Kanauj and the annexation of Malwa, Govinda III turned to the south. We are told in an inscription that Govinda 'terrified the Kerala, Pandya and the Chola kings and caused the Pallavas to wither.
- The Ganga (of Karnataka), who became dissatisfied through baseness, were bound down with fetters and met with death.' The king of Lanka and his minister who had been negligent of their own interests, were captured and brought over as prisoners to Halapur. Two statues of the lord of Lanka were carried to Manyakhet, and installed like pillars of victory in front of a Siva temple.
- **Amoghavarsha** ruled for 64 years but by temperament he preferred the pursuit of religion and literature to war. He was **himself an author and is credited with writing the first Kannada book on poetics known as Kavirajamarga.** He was a great builder, and is said to have built the capital city **Manyakhet** so as to excel the city of Indra. **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 90.C

- The caves of Bhimbetka were discovered in **1957–58** by eminent archaeologist **V. S. Wakankar** and later on, many more were discovered. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The rock art of Bhimbetka has been classified into various groups on the bases of style, technique, and superimposition. The drawings and paintings can be categorized into seven historical periods. Period I,

Upper Palaeolithic; Period II, Mesolithic; and Period III, Chalcolithic. After Period III there are four successive periods.

- **The largest number of Bhimbetka paintings belong to Period II which covers the Mesolithic paintings.**
 - **During this period the themes are multiple but the paintings are smaller in size compared to Upper Palaeolithic paintings. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - Hunting scenes predominate. The hunting scenes depict people hunting in groups, armed with barbed spears, pointed sticks, arrows and bows. In some paintings, these primitive men are shown with traps and snares probably to catch animals.
 - The hunters are shown wearing simple clothes and ornaments. Sometimes, men have been adorned with elaborate headdresses, and sometimes painted with masks also.
 - Elephant, bison, tiger, boar, deer, antelope, leopard, panther, rhinoceros, fish, frog, lizard, squirrel, and at times birds are also depicted.
 - The Mesolithic artists loved to paint animals. In some pictures, animals are chasing men. In others, they are being chased and hunted by men. Some of the animal paintings, especially in the hunting scenes, show fear of animals, but many others show a feeling of tenderness and love for them.
 - **Though animals were painted in a naturalistic style, humans were depicted only in a stylistic manner. Hence statement 3 is correct.**
 - Women are painted both in the nude and clothed. The young and the old equally find their place in these paintings. Children are painted running, jumping, and playing. Community dances provide a common theme.
 - There are paintings of people gathering fruit or honey from trees, and of women grinding and preparing food.
 - Some of the pictures of men, women, and children seem to depict a sort of family life. In many of the rock shelters, we find handprints, fist prints, and dots made by the fingertips.
 - **The artists of Bhimbetka used many colors, including various shades of white, yellow, orange, red ochre, purple, brown, green, and black. But white and red were their favorite colors.**

Q 91.A

- Dhrupad is one of the oldest and grandest forms of Hindustani Classical Music. The essential quality of the dhrupadic approach is its sombre atmosphere and emphasis on rhythm.
 - **There were four schools or vanis of singing the dhrupad.**
 - ✓ **The Gauhar vani** developed the raga or unadorned melodic figures.
 - ✓ **The Dagarvani** emphasized melodic curves and graces.
 - ✓ **The Khandar vani** specialised in quick ornamentation of the notes.
 - ✓ **Nauhar vani** was known for its broad musical leaps and jumps.
 - ✓ These vanis 'are now indistinguishable.
- Today the pride of place in classical Hindustani Music is occupied by **the Khyal**. The word is alien and means 'imagination'. **It is more lyrical than the dhrupad. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **Comparable to the vanis of the dhrupad, we have gharanas, in the khyal.** These are schools of singing founded or developed by various individuals or patrons such as kings or noblemen. The oldest of these is the Gwalior gharana. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 92.D

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Aits from Pallava and Chola dynasties represent the eternal struggle between the forces of good and evil, in which the good ultimately triumphs.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The mighty Cholas who succeeded the Pallavas and ruled over South India from the 9th to 13th centuries A.D. created the great temples at Thanjavur, Gangai Kondo Cholapuram, Darasurama, which are a veritable treasure house of their art. **A good example of Chola craftsmanship in the 11th century is the relief carving of Siva as Gajurasamaharamurti. The irate god is engaged in a vigorous dance of fierce ecstasy after having killed the elephant demon, who has given so much trouble to the rishis and his devotees.** The hide of the demon is spread aloft by the god, using it as a sort of cover. Devi stands at the lower right corner as the only awe-struck spectator of the divine act of retribution.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **The Pallava style concerns itself with a tall and slender physiognomical form.** The thin and elongated limbs emphasize the tallness of the figure. **The female figures are much lighter in appearance, with their slender waists, narrow chests, and shoulders, smaller breasts, sparse ornaments and garments, and generally submissive attitudes.** The figure sculpture of the Pallavas is natural in pose and modelling. The front of the torso is almost flat, and the ornamentations are

simple in high relief. Yet it is infused with a certain amount of vigor and fluid grace. A **great masterpiece is the carving from Mahabalipuram showing the great goddess Durga engaged in a fierce battle with the buffalo-headed demon aided by their respective armies.** Riding on her lion she is rushing at the powerful demon with great courage. He is moving away, yet watching for a moment to attack.

Q 93.C

- The army of the Delhi Sultans comprised of Cavalry, Infantry and Elephantry. The cavalryman was referred as "**asatvar**" and was usually armed with a bow and arrows, sword, mace, lance, lasso etc. The earliest evidence regarding the appearance of the Turkish cavalry is found on the coins of Sultan Iltutmish. **Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
- The most important department of state, next to the wazir's was the diwan- i-arz or the military department. The head of this department was called the **ariz-i-mamalik**. The **ariz was not the commander-in-chief** of the army, since the sultan himself commanded all the armed forces. **Hence pair 2 is not correctly matched.**
 - The special responsibility of the ariz's department was to recruit, equip and pay the army.
- **The rulers posted intelligence agents called barids** in different parts of the empire to keep them informed of what was going on. Only a nobleman who enjoyed the fullest confidence of the ruler was **appointed the chief barid**. **Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.**

Q 94.D

- **The decorative forms of Indo-Islamic architecture** included designing on plaster through **incision or stucco**. The designs were either left plain or covered with colors.
 - **Motifs were also painted on or carved in stone.** These motifs included varieties of flowers, both from the sub-continent and places outside, particularly Iran.
 - **The lotus bud fringe was used to great advantage in the inner curves of the arches.**
 - Walls were also decorated with cypress, chinar, and other trees as also with flower vases.
 - Many complex designs of flower motifs decorating the ceilings were also to be found on textiles and carpets.
 - In the fourteenth, fifteenth, and sixteenth centuries tiles were also used to surface the walls and the domes.
 - ✓ **Popular colors were blue, turquoise, green, and yellow.**
 - ✓ Subsequently, the **techniques of tessellation (mosaic designs) and pietra dura** were made use of for surface decoration, particularly in the dado panels of the walls.
 - ✓ At times lapis lazuli was used in the interior walls or on canopies.
 - Other decorations included **arabesque, calligraphy** and high and low relief carving, and profuse use of jalis. The high-relief carving has a three-dimensional look. The arches were plain and squat and sometimes high and pointed.
 - ✓ From the sixteenth century onwards arches were designed with trefoil or multiple foliations.
 - ✓ Spandrels of the arches were decorated with medallions or bosses.
 - The roof was a mix of the central dome and other smaller domes, chhatris, and tiny minarets. The central dome was topped with an inverted lotus flower motif and a metal or stone pinnacle.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 95.B

- Shivaji had laid the foundations of a sound system of administration. Shivaji's system of administration was largely borrowed from the administrative practices of the Deccani states. Although he designated eight ministers, sometimes called the Ashtapradhan, it was not in the nature of a council of ministers, each minister being directly responsible to the ruler.
- The Ashtapradhan of Shivaji consisted of the following 8 officials:
 - Peshwa, who looked after general administration and finances.
 - Sari-i-naubat or senapati
 - **Majumdar, who was an accountant. Hence pair 3 is not correctly matched.**
 - **Wakenavis, who was responsible for intelligence, posts and household affairs. Hence pair 1 is correctly matched.**
 - Suranavis or chitnis, who helped in correspondence.
 - Dabir. who was master of ceremonies.
 - Nyayadhish, was in charge of justice.
 - **Panditrao, was in charge of charitable grants. Hence pair 2 is correctly matched.**

Q 96.D

- Although a substantial number of non-producing people concentrated in the cities, the age of the Shakas, Kushans, Satavahanas (200 BC-AD 250), and the first Tamil states was the most flourishing period in the history of crafts and commerce in ancient India. Arts and crafts in particular witnessed remarkable growth.
 - We do not hear of so many kinds of artisans in the earlier texts as are mentioned in the writings of the period. The **Digha Nikaya**, which relates to pre-Maurya times, mentions nearly two dozen occupations, but the **Mahavastu**, which relates to this period, catalogs thirty-six kinds of workers living in the town of Rajgir, and the list is not exhaustive.
 - The **Milinda Panho or the Questions of Milinda** enumerates as many as seventy-five occupations, sixty of which are connected with various crafts. A **Tamil text known in English as The Garland of Madurai** supplements the information supplied by the two Buddhist texts on crafts and craftsmen. This text does not distinguish between craftsmen and shopkeepers.
- **Types of Merchants:** The **Buddhist texts mention the sresthi, who was the chief merchant** of the nigama, and the **sarthavaha, the caravan leader who was the head of the corporation of merchants** (vanijgramo). It also speaks of nearly half a dozen petty merchants called vanija.
- To them we can add **perfumers or all-purpose merchants called gandhika**. Various types of oilmen, some of them dealing in perfumed oils, are covered by the term. The **term vyavahari, that is, one who transacts business**, is also used, but the term vyapari or trader seems to be missing.
- The term agrivaniya seems to be obscure, but these merchants may have been the predecessors of the agrawalas if we allow for some linguistic change. Whatever may be the meaning of this term, there were certainly wholesale merchants who conducted both internal and external trade. **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 97.B

- Of all the foreign travellers to the Vijayanagara Empire, Domingo Paes' recordings are of unique values as they provide first hand vivid and graphic account of his personal experiences.
 - **Domingo Paes** was a Portuguese traveller who visited Vijayanagara Empire around the year 1520. Paes visited the capital under the rule of Krishna Deva Raya.
 - Paes recorded his impressions of Vijayanagara state in his Chronica dos reis de Bisnaga. This chronicle is dated around 1525, and talks about the history of Vijayanagara but gives much more weight to other aspects of the Empire and its commercial dimension, architecture, religion and customs, bureaucracy and in ultimately, every day of the city and its empire.
 - He describes a busy market of precious stones. The city was prospering and its size, in the eyes of the narrator, was comparable to Rome, with abundant vegetation, aqueducts and artificial lakes.
 - There are references to the "great feast" in the writings of the medieval traveller Domingo Paes. Referring to the "great feast of nine days", Domingo Paes refers to a structure as the House of Victory which historians equate with the Mahanavami Dibba.
 - **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 98.A

- Akbar wanted to expand his empire and maintain his hold over it with a strong army. For this purpose, it was necessary for him to organize the nobility as well as his army. Akbar realised both these objectives by means of the mansabdari system. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- Under this system, every officer was assigned a rank (mansab). The lowest rank was 10, and the highest was 5000 for the nobles. Princes of the blood received higher mansabs.
- The mansab system under Akbar developed gradually. At first there was only one rank (mansab). From the fortieth year (1594—95), the ranks were divided into two—zat and sawar.
 - **The word zat means personal. It fixed the personal status of a person, and also the salary due to him.**
 - **The sawar rank indicated the number of cavalymen (sawars) a person was required to maintain.** A person who was required to maintain as many sawars as his zat rank was placed in the first category of that rank; if he maintained half or more, then in the second category and if he maintained less than half then in the third category. Thus, there were three categories in every rank (mansab). **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The salary due to the soldiers were added to the salary of the mansabdar, who was paid by assigning to him a jagir. **Sometimes, the mansabdars were paid in cash.** It is wrong to think that Akbar did not like

the jagir system and tried to do away with it, but failed as it was too deeply entrenched. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

- A jagir did not confer any hereditary rights on the holder, or disturb any of the existing rights in the area. It only meant that the land revenue due to the state was to be paid to the jagirdar.

Q 99.B

- **Recently, Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly has passed two bills that seek to transfer the Governor's power in appointing Vice-Chancellors of 13 state universities to the state government.**
- **Education comes under the Concurrent List**, but entry 66 of the Union List — “coordination and determination of standards in institutions for higher education or research and scientific and technical institutions” — gives the Centre substantial authority over higher education. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- According to the Central University regulation, 2009, and other laws, in the case of central universities, **the President of India becomes an ex officio Visitor of the university.** Chancellors are nominal heads in the central universities, appointed by the President as visitors, and are restricted to presiding over convocations. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The UGC plays that standard-setting role, even in the case of appointments in universities and colleges. According to the UGC (Minimum Qualifications for Appointment of Teachers and other Academic Staff in Universities and Colleges and other Measures for the Maintenance of Standards in Higher Education) Regulations, 2018, **the “Visitor/Chancellor” — mostly the Governor in states — shall appoint the VC out of the panel of names recommended by search-cum-selection committees. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Higher educational institutions, particularly those that get UGC funds, are mandated to follow its regulations. These are usually followed without friction in the case of central universities but are sometimes resisted by the states in the case of state universities.

Q 100.C

- Muhammad Husayn al-Katib Kashmiri (c. 1575-1605), was the most celebrated calligrapher at the court of the emperor Akbar, who gave him the title of Zarrin Qalam (Golden Pen). He continued to work at the court of Jahangir and his recorded work is dated between (1580-1608 AD).
- He was a master of **Nasta'liq** (Calligraphic style) and a pupil of 'Abd al-'Aziz. Abul Fazal in A'in-i Akbari considers his handwriting to be equal to that of Mir 'Ali.
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**